MODULE 2
Finding Ideas
From Problems to Opportunities

ASSIGNMENT: 20+ ideas → ONE tested favorite + 5 recorded interviews booked

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Check-In:

How much new revenue did you sign?

Today

Check-in & progress — 10 conversations, what did they say? (15')

IDEA 1 · Good ideas are noticed, not brainstormed (10')

IDEA 2 · Diverge, then converge — volume first, one gate (10')

IDEA 3 · Mom Test Quickstart — interview like a scientist (15')

IDEA 4 · Founder-problem fit: why YOU, why THIS, why NOW (10')

Case · Isar Aerospace: a billion-euro idea in a student club (30')

Workshop · Idea Stress Test (90')

Wrap-up · one idea, five booked interviews (5')

From Module 1: Teambuilding

1. You formed teams based on complementary skills & shared interests
2. You identified your top 3 problems worth exploring
3. Today: We'll use our team to find startup problems

Problems → Ideas → Opportunities → Ventures

Show us where you‘re at in 3 Minutes or less!

What did you do?	What did you learn?	How can we help?

Make it credible:

1. **Facts:** Statistics or Research: What do they say? What does it mean? Where are they from?
2. **Numbers:** Usage or Surveys: How were they reported? How did they change? Why is it relevant?
3. **Quotes:** Interviews or Testemonials: What did they say? Why did they say it? What could this mean?
4. **Images:** Screenshots or Users: What happened? What changed? Why is it relevant?

IDEA 1: Ideas are noticed, not brainstormed

The best startup ideas aren't invented in workshops. They're noticed — by people living close enough to a problem to smell it.

Live in the future, then build what's missing. Isar's founders noticed Europe's launch gap from inside a rocketry club.

„But if someone steals my idea“ – The Idea Myth

"Ideas are worth nothing. Execution is everything."

— Paul Graham, Y Combinator

The Startup Paradox:

- 80% of founders didn't start with the final idea
- Airbnb started as selling cereal boxes
- Slack was a failed video game company
- Instagram was a check-in app called Burbn

What matters more than the idea:

1. Your ability to iterate fast
2. Your obsession with the problem
3. Your team's ability to execute

Where ideas really come from

Source 1: Problems You Have

The best founders solve their own problems. You understand the pain deeply.

Source 2: Things That Seem Missing

"Why doesn't X exist?" questions often reveal opportunities.

Source 3: Domain Expertise

Deep knowledge in a field lets you see what others miss.

Source 4: Technology Shifts

New capabilities (AI, mobile, crypto) unlock new possibilities.

The Formula: Expertise × Pain × New Tech = Opportunity

Problem-First Thinking

Common Mistake: Starting with a solution

"I want to build an app that..." ← Wrong starting point

Better Approach: Starting with a problem

"I noticed that [people] struggle with [pain]..." ← Right starting point

The Problem Space:

- WHO has this problem? (Customer segment)
- WHAT is the obstacle they face? (Pain point)
- WHY do they want to solve it? (Motivation)
- HOW are they solving it today? (Workaround)

If you can't answer these, you don't understand the problem yet.

IDEA 2: Diverge, then converge

Round one is a numbers game: volume beats precision, silence beats groupthink.

Then ONE gate — DVF, ten minutes, evidence only — and you leave with a single idea worth testing.

Crazy 8s — volume, twice

8 ideas in 8 minutes. On paper. In silence. No filtering, no judging — ugly counts.

Round 2, with constraints: AI-powered · buildable for <€500 · customers you can reach THIS week.

Silence is the trick: speaking in groups blocks production; solo-then-share beats brainstorming out loud (next slide).

Then converge. You leave the workshop with ONE idea — not a portfolio.

DVF — a 10-minute gate, not a canvas

Score each surviving idea 1–5, from EVIDENCE you hold — not vibes:

- DESIRABLE — did anyone you actually spoke to have this problem this month?
- VIABLE — is there a plausible price a named person would pay?
- FEASIBLE — can THIS team ship a first test in two weeks?

Below 10/15: the idea dies now, politely. You are not filling a canvas — you are choosing where to spend your next 10 interviews.

What the evidence says

Brainstorming out loud underperforms: 'production blocking' — people queue instead of think (Diehl & Stroebe 1987).

Hybrid beats both extremes: individuals generate, groups select (Girotra, Terwiesch & Ulrich 2010, Management Science).

Lead users see needs years before the market — hang out where the problem lives (von Hippel 1986). That's what a rocketry club is.

That's exactly the workshop design: silent Crazy 8s → group DVF gate → one idea into the field.

IDEA 3: Mom Test Quickstart

Your homework is 5 recorded interviews — so you learn the method TODAY, not next week.

Five rules: past not future · facts not opinions · their life not your idea · never pitch · record it.

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Mom Test Quickstart — interview like a scientist

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Basic script of an interview guideline

Ask the right questions

1. Tell me a story about the last time _____.
2. What was hardest?
3. Why was that hard?
4. How do you solve it now?
5. Why is that not awesome?

Repeat

„Tell my another Situation“ (Start with 1 again)

5-why‘s

Dig deep to understand the core issues



Ask open questions

You have to talk as less as possible.
So you can learn as much as possible!

Open Questions

- Can you tell me more about the challenges you're facing with your team?
- How do you envision your company's growth over the next year?
- What strategies have you tried so far to resolve the issue, and what were the outcomes?
- How do you feel about the current direction of your business?
- What are your primary goals for the next quarter?

Closed Questions

- Are you satisfied with your current team structure?
- Do you feel supported by your co-founders?
- Have you considered pivoting your business model?
- Is employee retention a significant concern for your company?
- Are you currently seeking external funding?

Listen, observe and ask questions with an open mind

Don‘t talk about your product! -> As soon as you start pitching your mind changes gears. It goes from learning and absorbing information into selling a product.



3-P Rule

Practice!

Practice!

Practice!

- Get aware when asking leading questions
- When you start you sales pitch
- You can always practice with a coworker!



Recording is your friend

You can do it locally with a stack like:

- Whisper
- Ollama
- Obsidian



Tell people that you do transcribe for docu purposes. Do not save voice recordings.

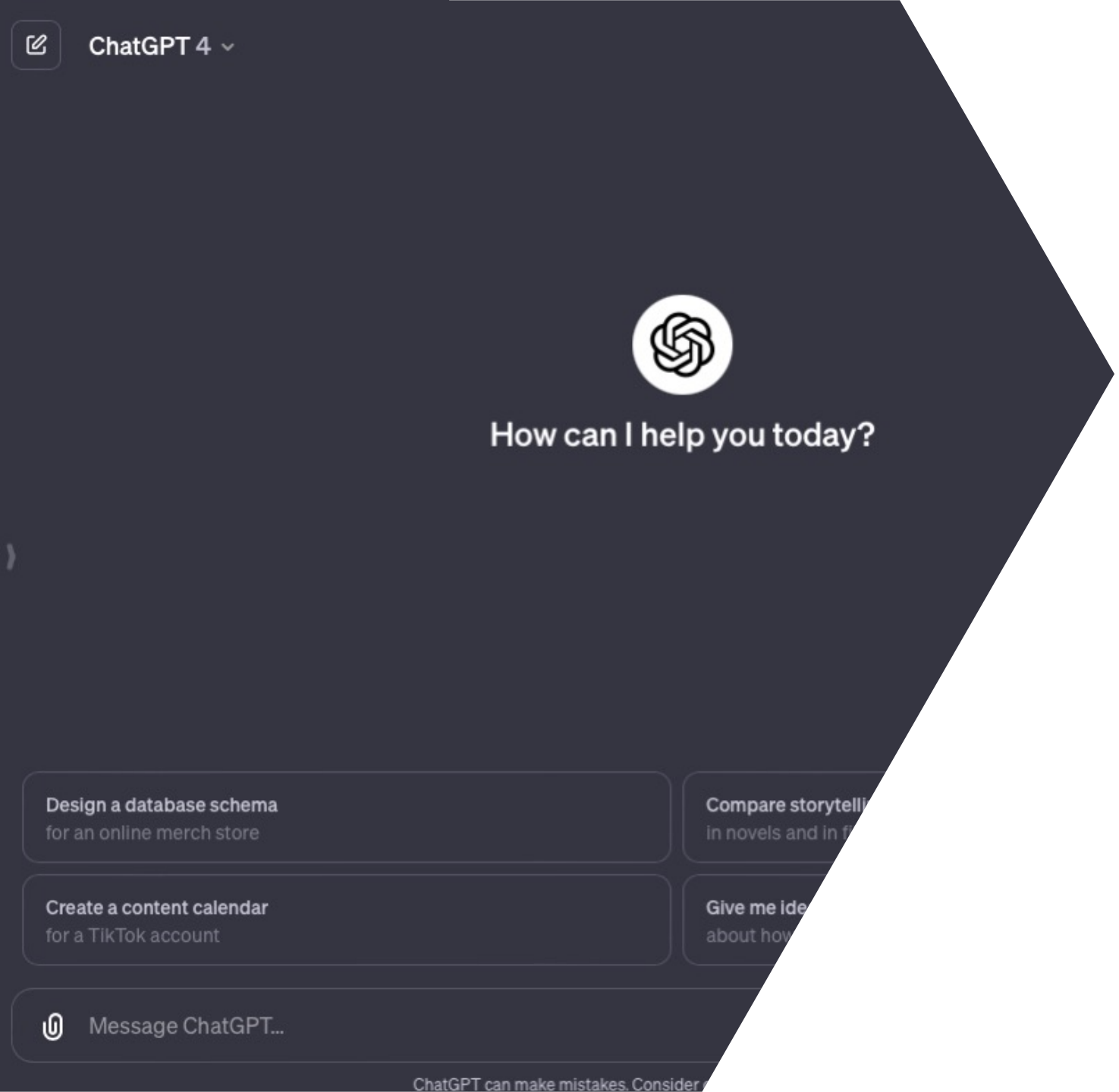
Creating Interviews 1/2

Structured Interview	Semi Structured Interview	Unstructured Interview
Predefined and often standardized interview guide Sometimes uses standardizes answers	Use of guiding themes Only a few explicit questions Interview structure predetermined	Some opening guidance No predefined structure or questions Emergent performance
Easy to control, integration of various answers, ability to focus Rather strong interference, risk of biases, limits interviews' inherent richness	Provides a framework, makes sure a little focus remains, allows for some emergence Can still serve as blinders, more difficult to get clearance for	Ability to tap into subjects' own life worlds, very little interference Almost impossible to get clearance for, put very high demands on interviewer's skills, High effort for unsure benefit

Anecdotes

Creating Interviews 2/2

Gather Intel	Background of the person you are talking to Background of the company that person works for
Set the Stage	Thank the participant for participating Clarify the time and scope of the interview Clarify the terms, method and goal of this interview
Do the Interview	Prepare best practice interview questions Allow 5-10 Minutes per question (dig deep) Make use of a supporter to protocol and check the interview
Follow Through	What else does the interviewee want to talk about? Who should we also talk to about this topic? May we come back if new questions arise? Do you want to have a summary of the results?



VENTURE LABS

Let‘s ChatGPT our Customers

A joint initiative by

UNTER NEHMER TUM



Note:

Use AI to understand Problems
Not to find solutions

IDEA 4: Founder-problem fit

A good idea for someone else can be a bad idea for you.

Why YOU (unfair insight or access) · why THIS (a problem you want to live with) · why NOW (what changed?).

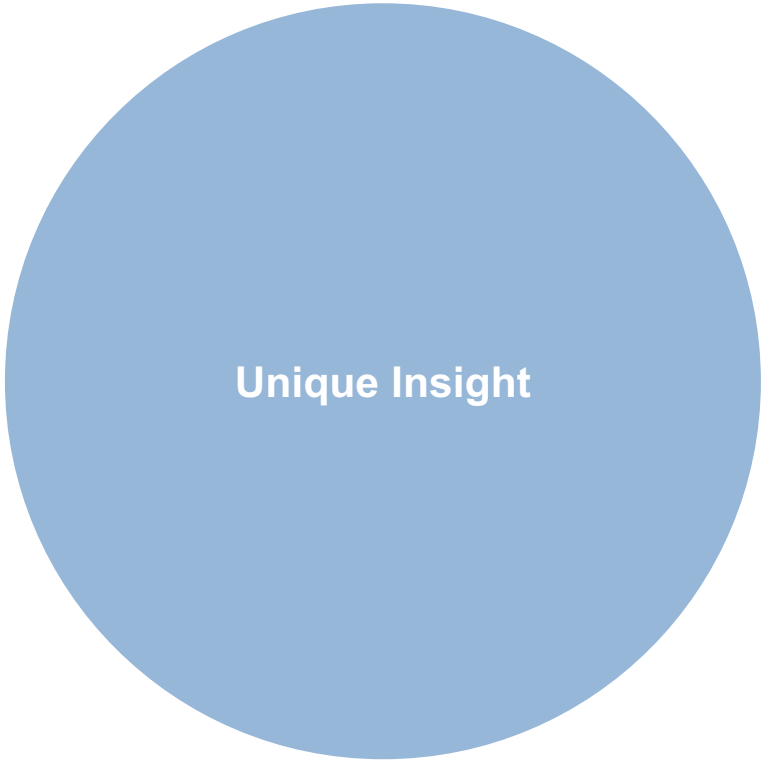
Problem-Founder-Fit

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Unique Insight

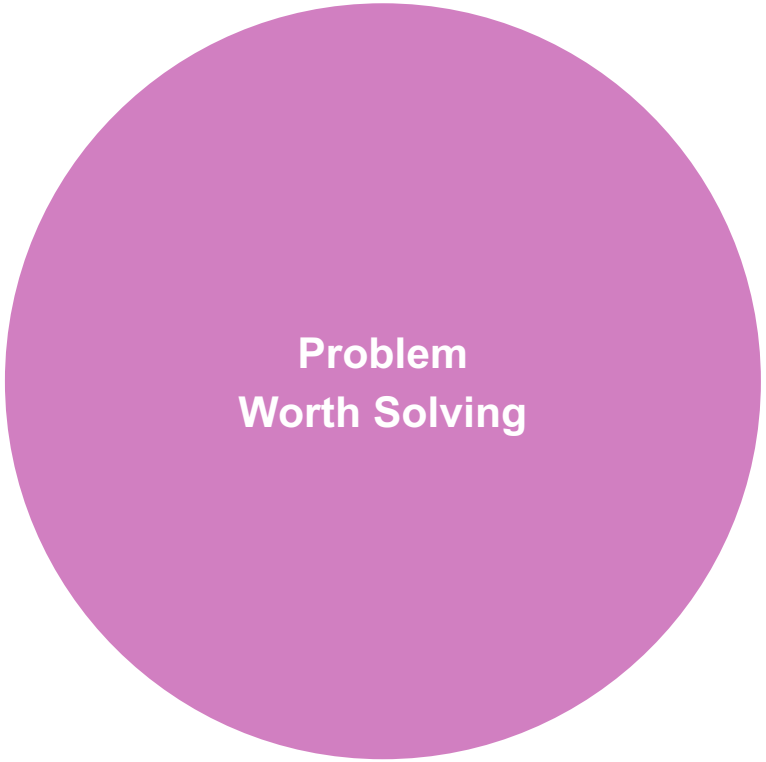


Why do other people think you‘re weird?

What is something unique you do or know?

- Apprenticeship/School
- Personal Conviction
- Vita or personal history
- Technical Knowledge or Expertise
- …

Problem worth solving



What is worth solving for you?

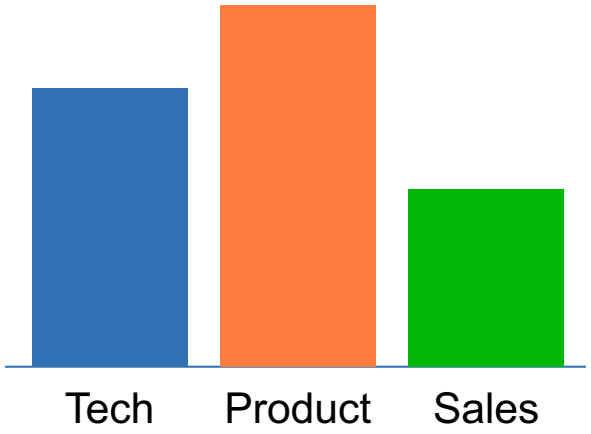
- Is the problem big enough so you can serve many people?
- Does it improve the lifes of people around you?
- Do you desire a world with this problem solved?
- Is someone willing to pay for it?
- …

Executable by the team

Executable by the team

Why are your uniquely suited for this challenge?

- Passion
- Determination
- Skills
- Experience
- …



Problems and Solutions

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END RECAP — today in four lines

1 · Ideas are noticed — go live where problems are visible

2 · Diverge in silence, converge with one evidence-based gate

3 · Mom Test: past, facts, their life, never pitch, record

4 · Founder-problem fit: why you, why this, why now

This week: 5 recorded interviews with named humans. Simulated users are practice, never evidence.

→ **Next week (Problem Space): your 5 recorded interviews become the Pain Map — and your interviewees become next month's first customers.**

Workshop: Idea Stress Test (90 min)

Agenda lives in M02_Workshop_Idea-Stress-Test.md — including Peer Attack pairing (A↔B, two rotations).

Must produce: your top idea + a Mom Test interview script + 5 interviews BOOKED before you leave.

Kill criteria: your top idea survived because it's clever, not because anyone has the problem.

Wrapup & Checkout

Your Top Idea Is a Hypothesis

Not a decision — here's what happens to it over the next three weeks

M2 · TODAY

One idea survives the stress test — Mom Test interview script ready

→

THIS WEEK

5 Mom Test interviews, recorded + noted — hypothesis updated with evidence

→

M3 · PROBLEMS

Pain Map + JTBD: find the segment whose hair is on fire

→

M4 · VALIDATION

Landing page in their words — your interviewees become your first leads

Don't polish the idea this week — book the interviews. Evidence beats brainstorming.

This week — M02_Homework.md

1. Brainstorm further problems
2. Casually listen around for more problems
3. If you can, start clustering what you hear
4. Decide if there are things that genuenly excite you as a team

Thank You!

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APPENDIX — original slides (65 restored as images)

These pages from the pre-rework deck are not in the current flow. Source snapshot: Instructor/original-decks/M02_Lecture_ORIGINAL.pdf.

Mark each: KEEP (design pass rebuilds it properly, editable) or KILL. Nothing gets deleted without your call.

Check-In:

What is your Energy Level Today?

Check-In:

What was your most exciting finding?

Check-In:

What was your biggest road blocker?

Check-In:

How many users did you talk to?

Recap from last time

You‘re in the perfect storm…

Ray Dalio‘s model for financial life cycles*:

Stage	Description	U.S. Timeline Example	Key Risks
1: New Order Established	A post-war reset crowns a new reserve currency and global leader, fostering stability.	1944 Bretton Woods Agreement: USD becomes world reserve after WWII.	None—honeymoon phase.
2: Peace and Productive Debt	Borrowing fuels innovation and growth; prosperity blooms.	1950s–1960s: Post-war boom, infrastructure investments.	Over-reliance on easy credit.
3: Debt Bubble and Wealth Gap	Excessive borrowing inflates assets; inequality surges as inflation erodes purchasing power for the masses.	1970s–2000s: Housing/credit boom widens the rich-poor divide.	Social unrest from disparity.
4: Bubble Burst and Downturn	Debt implodes, triggering recession.	2008 Financial Crisis: Subprime meltdown.	Systemic contagion.
5: Money Printing and Debasement	Central banks flood the system with liquidity (e.g., QE), but it widens gaps and erodes currency value.	2008–2020: Trillions printed; inflation hits the vulnerable hardest.	Currency devaluation, asset bubbles.
6: Internal Conflict and External Wars	Populism rises; civil strife weakens the empire, inviting rivals.	2020s onward: Polarization, tariffs, and great-power rivalry (U.S.-China).	Revolution or invasion.
7: Restructuring and Reset	Debt is restructured (often painfully); a new order emerges.	Potential 2026+: “Financial heart attack” forces rewrite of global finance.	Total paradigm shift.

Maximum Opportunity

Productivity Crisis

(Clearing out inneficient competitors)

+

Free Capital

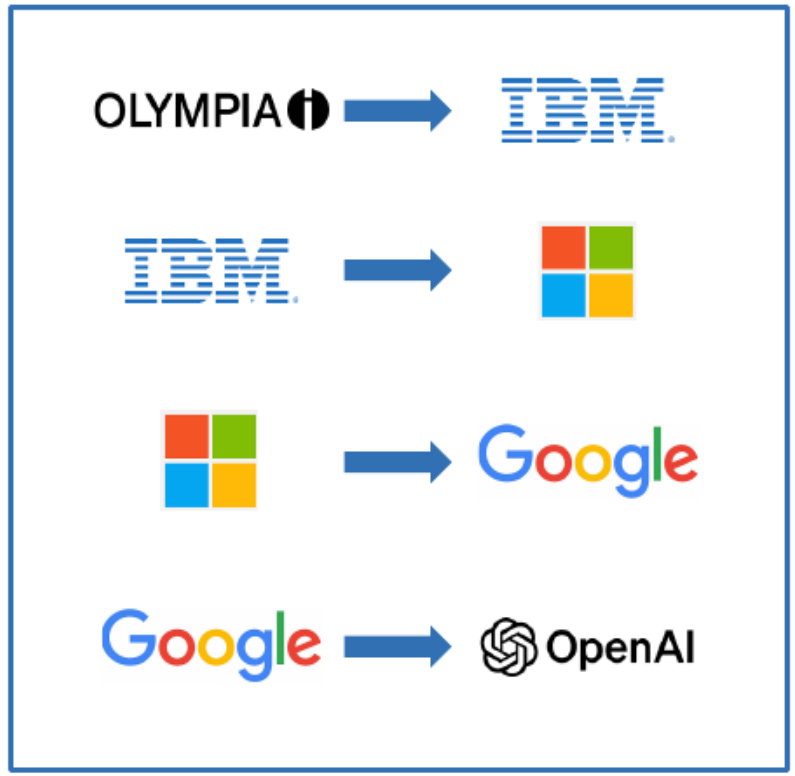
(Seeking new productive outlets)

+

Need for innovative Solutions

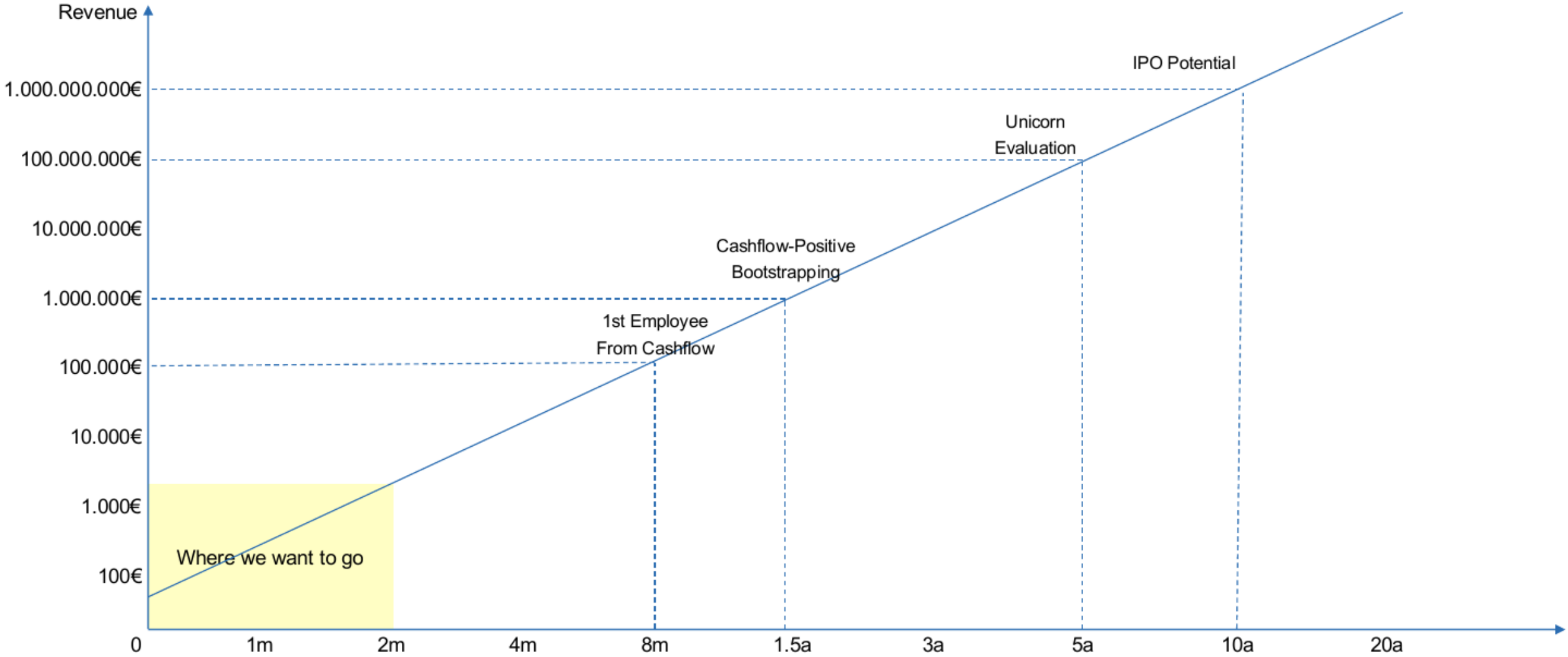
(Climate, Security, Demography, …)

New technological frontier:



*These stages are most relevant for the financial markets and don’t necessarily dramatic societal events

But it will take time.



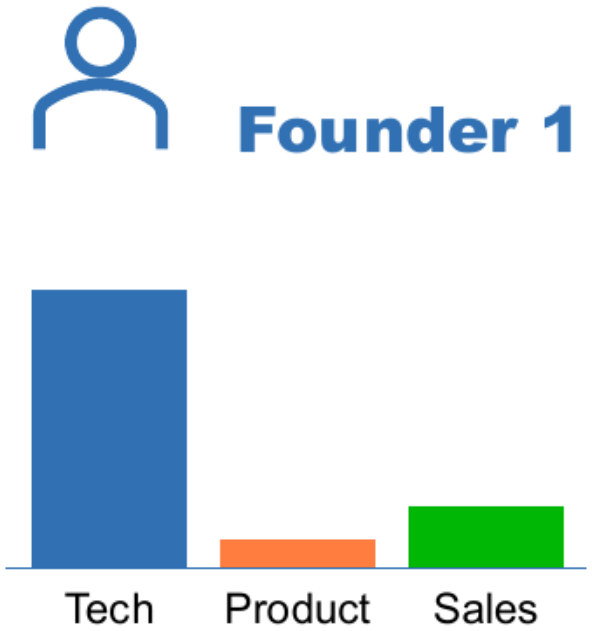
Not scientific reason behind this chart

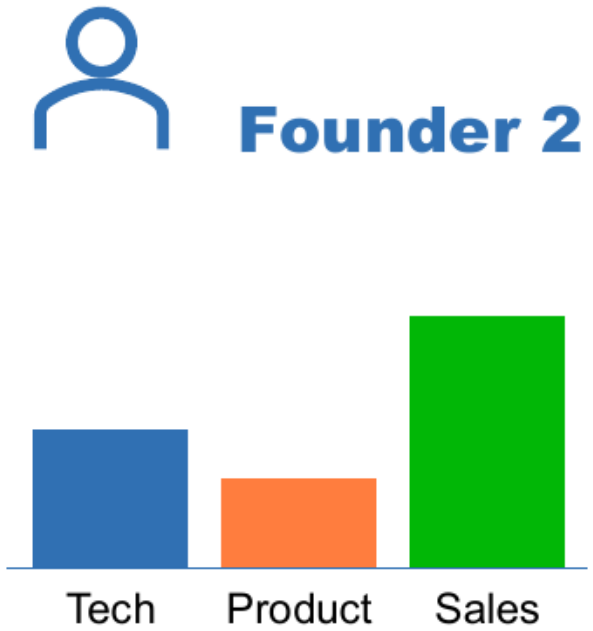
And you need to know which game you are playing.

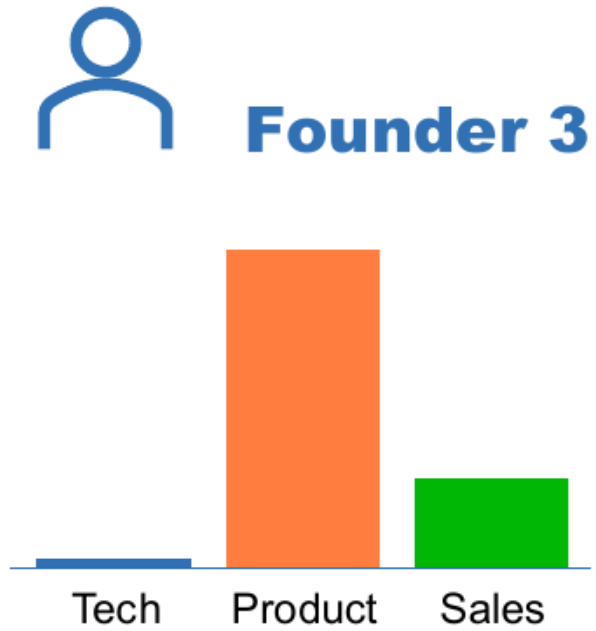




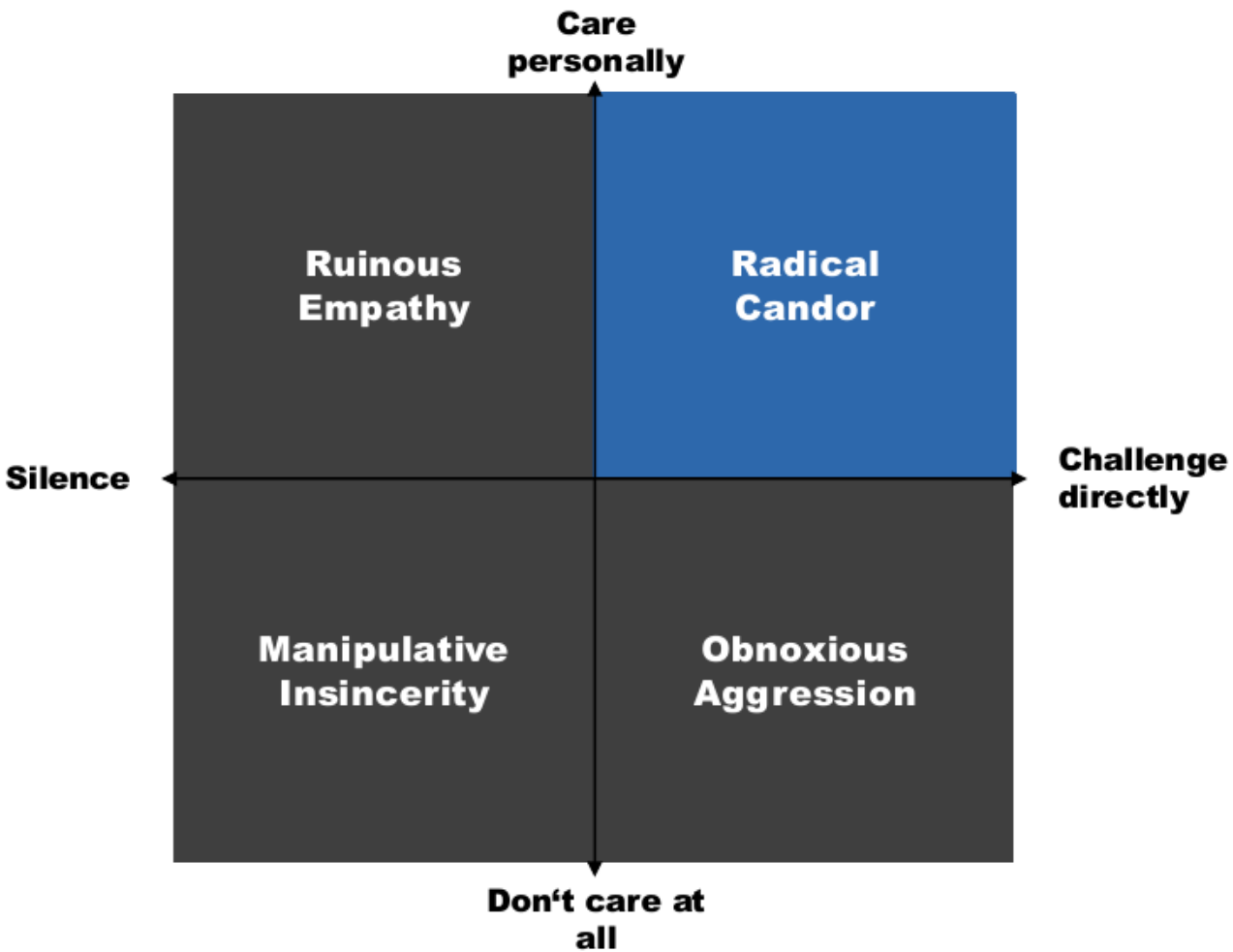
Build a team that is up to the task







And be open



Radical Candor is the crossroads of **Challenging Directly** and **Caring Personally**:

Caring Personally: Radical Candor starts with caring about the person you're addressing. It involves building strong relationships with your team members based on trust, empathy, and genuine concern for their well-being.

Challenging Directly: This means being willing to provide honest, straightforward feedback, even if it's uncomfortable. It's about addressing issues directly and not shying away from difficult conversations.

Your Presentations

Misconceptions about ideas

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Common Ideation Traps

❌ Solution Fixation

Building what's cool vs. what's needed

❌ Feature Creep

Adding more instead of validating the core

❌ Zombie Ideas

Refusing to kill ideas that aren't working

❌ Founder Delusion

"Everyone will want this" (no they won't)

❌ Analysis Paralysis

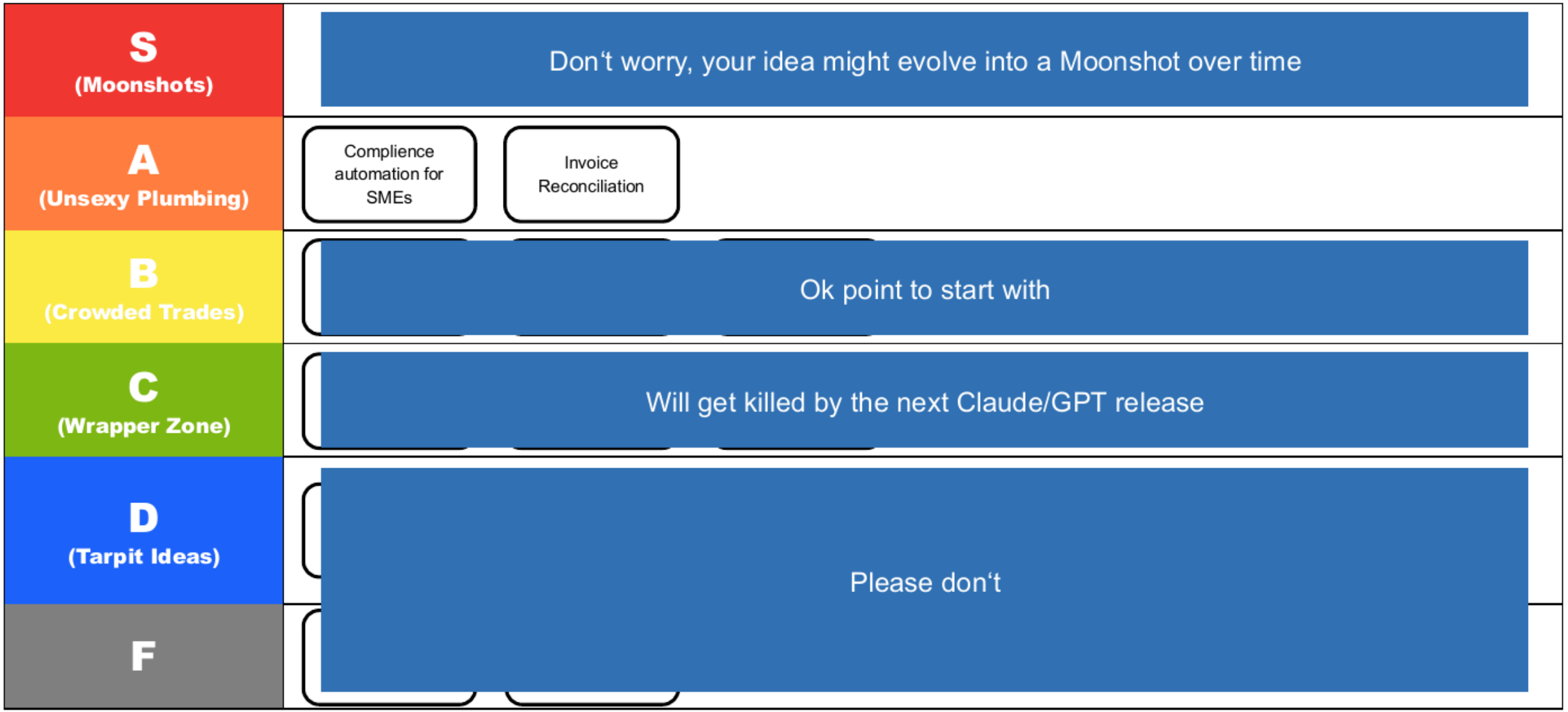
Researching forever instead of testing

✅ **The cure: Ship fast, talk to users, kill bad ideas quickly**

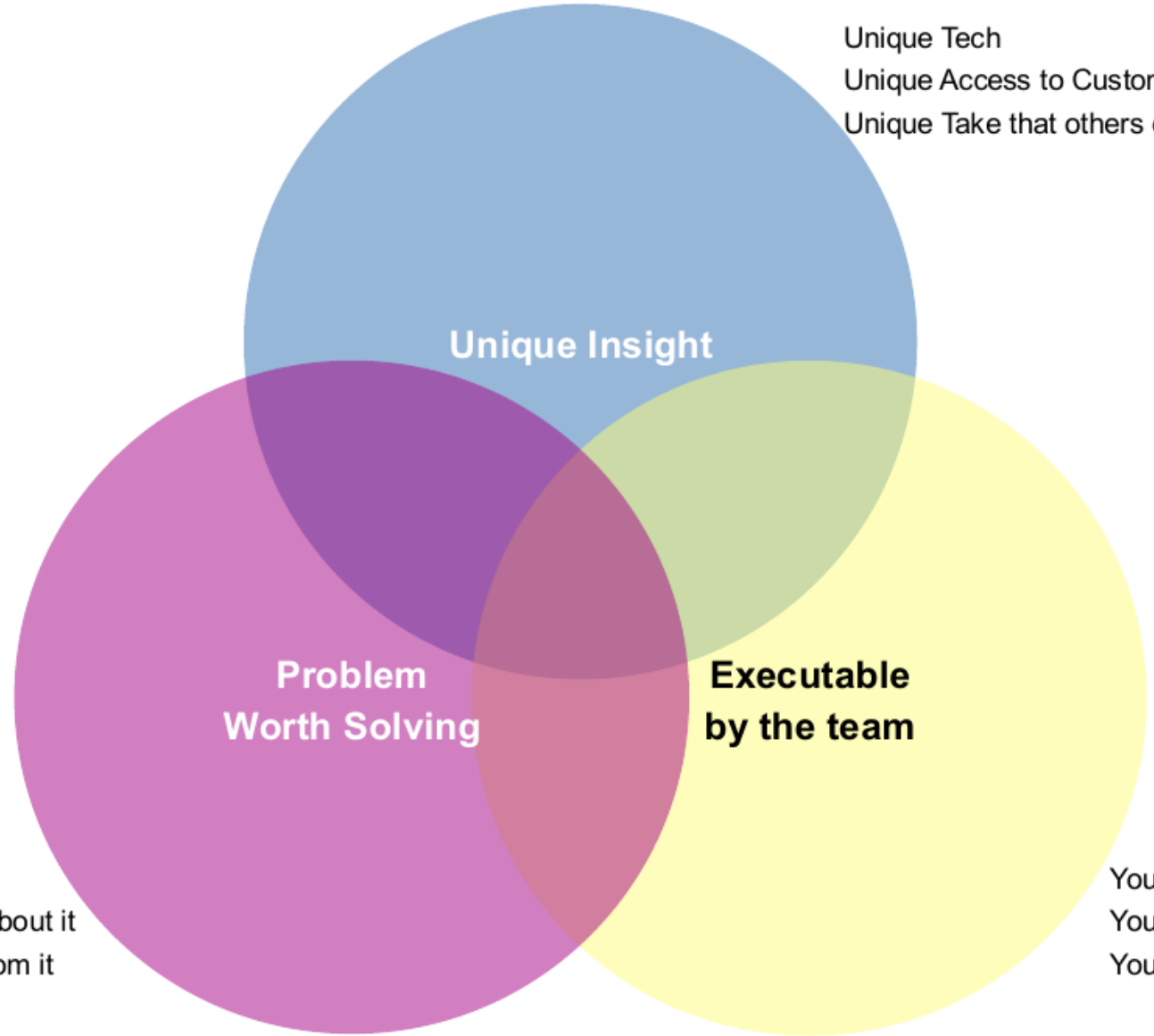
A Tier-List of Startup Ideas

S (Moonshots)	
A (Unsexy Plumbing)	Complience automation for SMEs; Invoice Reconciliation
B (Crowded Trades)	AI Project Management Tool; Improving knowledge management; Ed-Tech platform for universities
C (Wrapper Zone)	Chat with your files; GPT Cover Letter Generator; AI Meal Planner
D (Tarpit Ideas)	Apps to help you find places in new cities; Fitness trackers & Health apps; Social media for nieche audience; Language Learning App but with AI
F	Fridge Inventory App; Uber for dog walking

A Tier-List of Startup Ideas



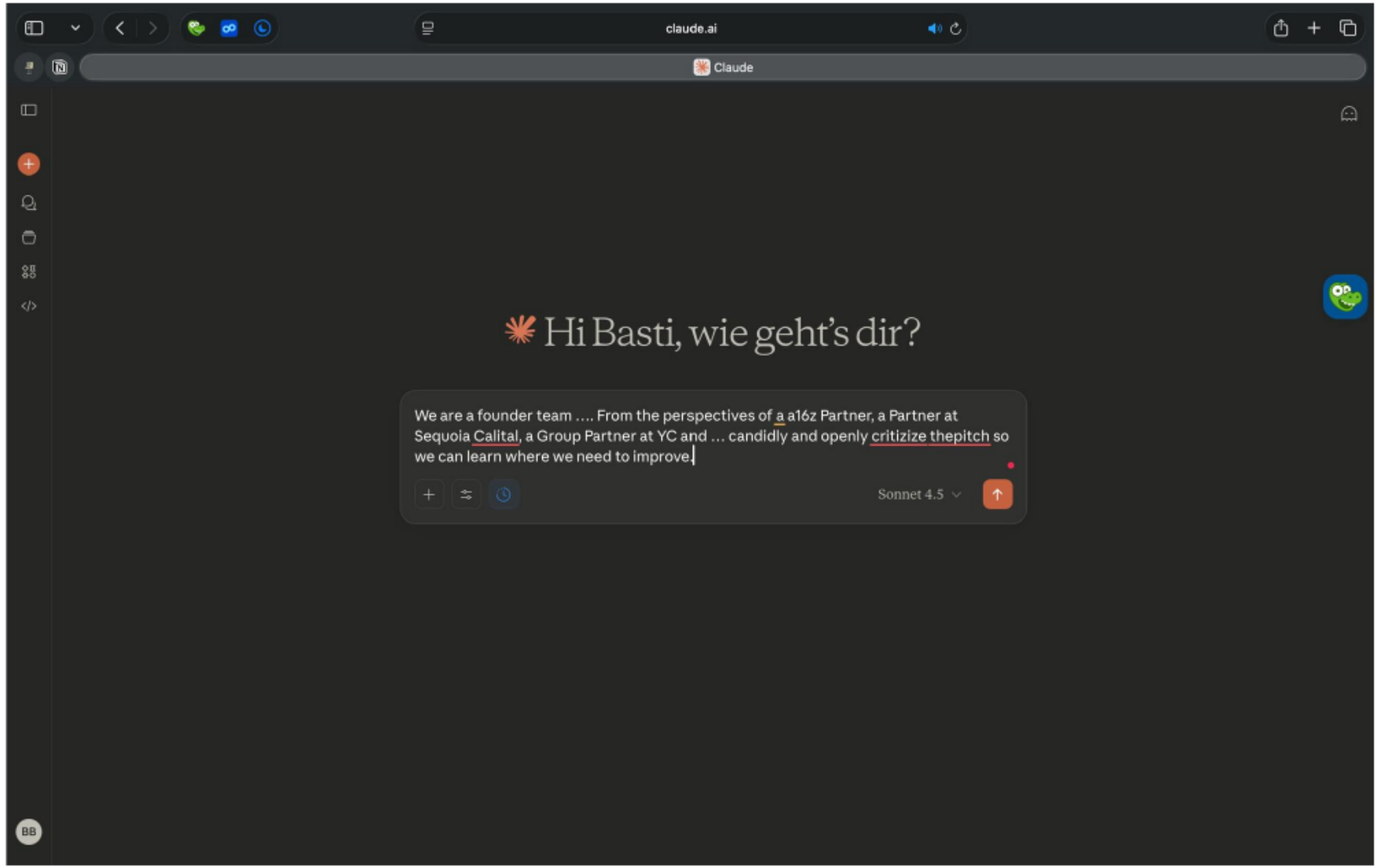
A Problem you want to have



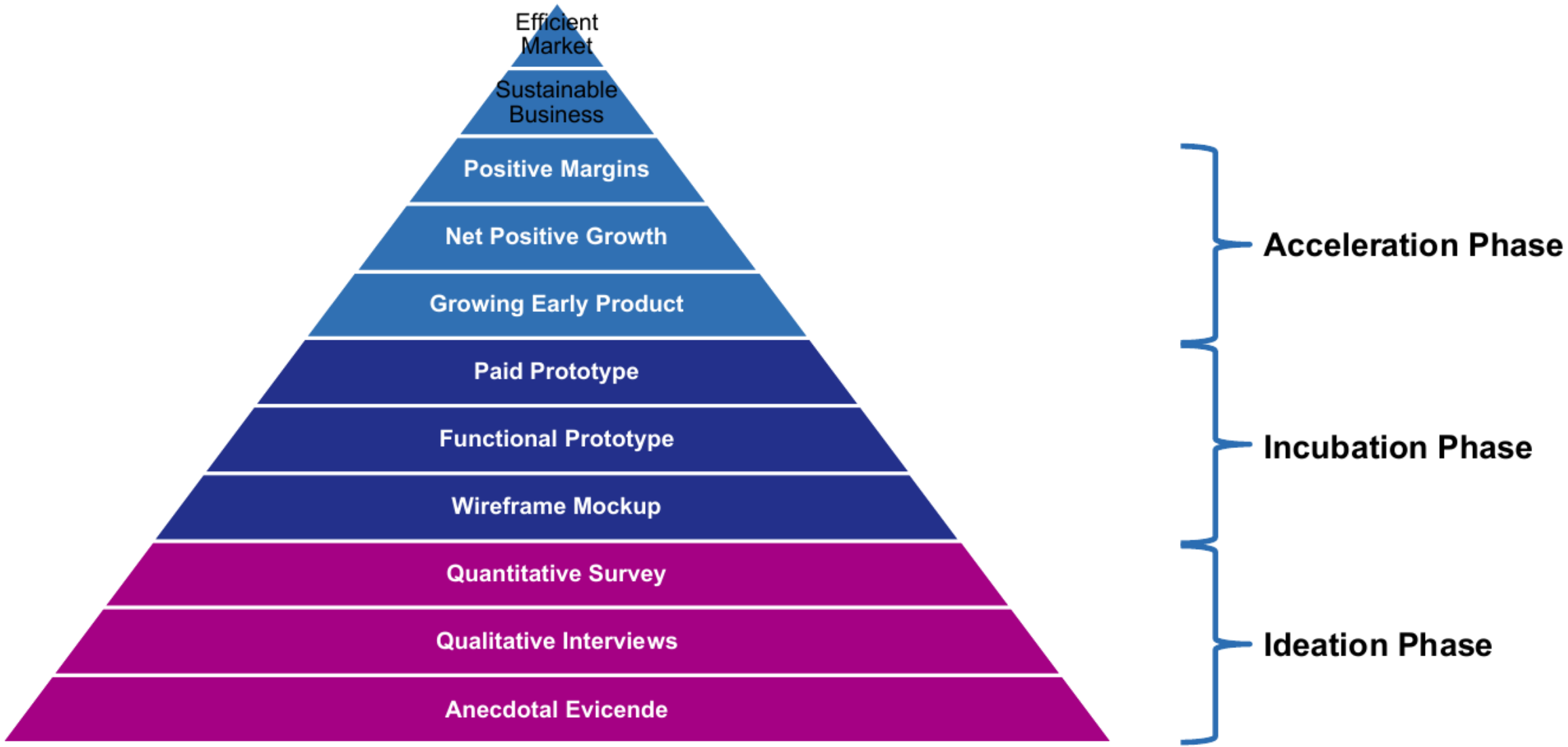
Unique Tech
Unique Access to Customers
Unique Take that others don't have

You are passionate about it
Your audience is passionate about it
You can make a good living from it

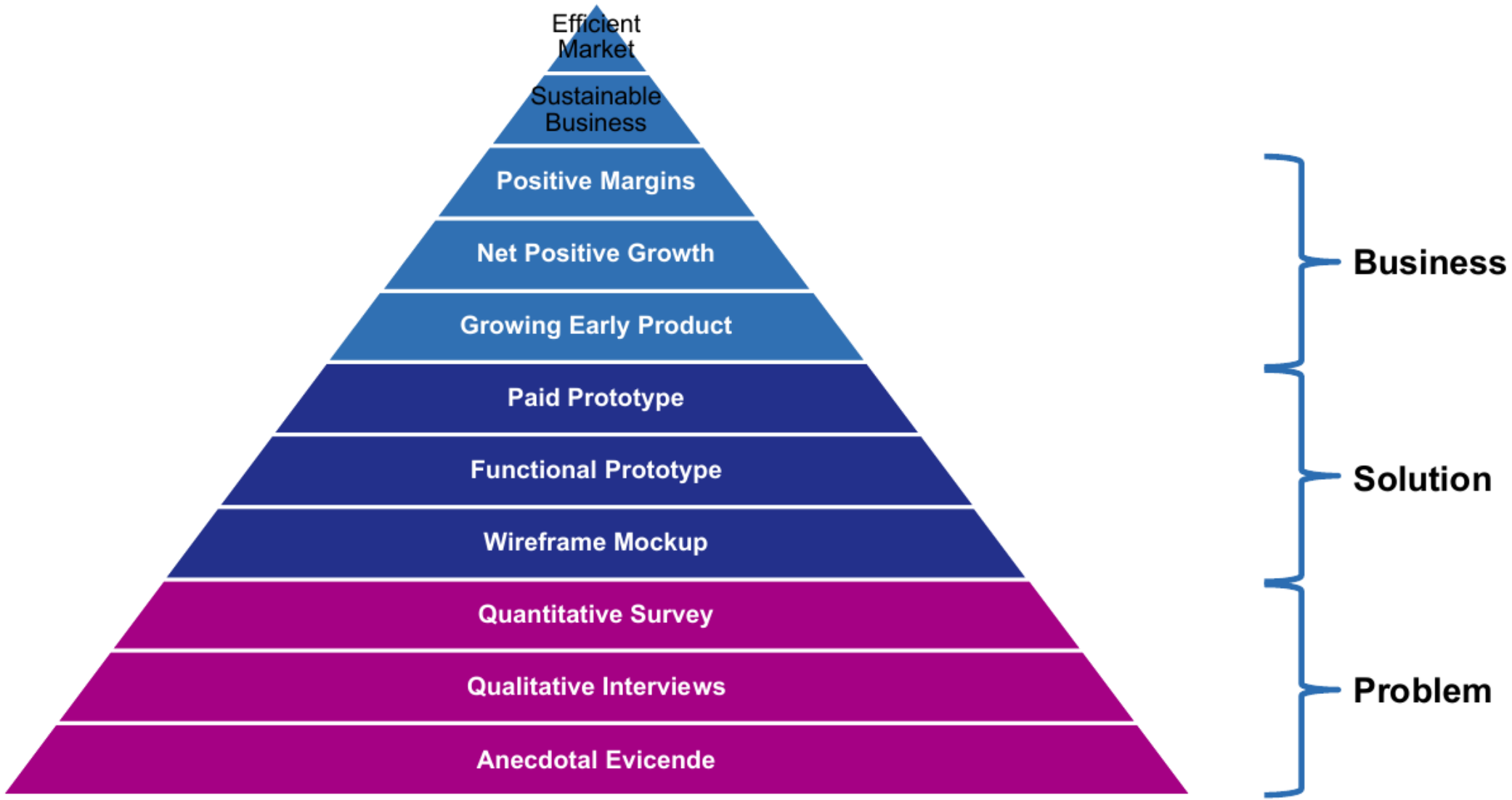
You can scale the product
You can scale the backend
You can scale the sales


claude.ai
Claude
Hi Basti, wie geht's dir?
We are a founder team .... From the perspectives of a a16z Partner, a Partner at Sequoia Calital, a Group Partner at YC and ... candidly and openly critizize thepitch so we can learn where we need to improve.
Sonnet 4.5
BB

Hirarchy of evidence in the lean startup



Hirarchy of evidence in the lean startup



Working with Anecdotal Evidence

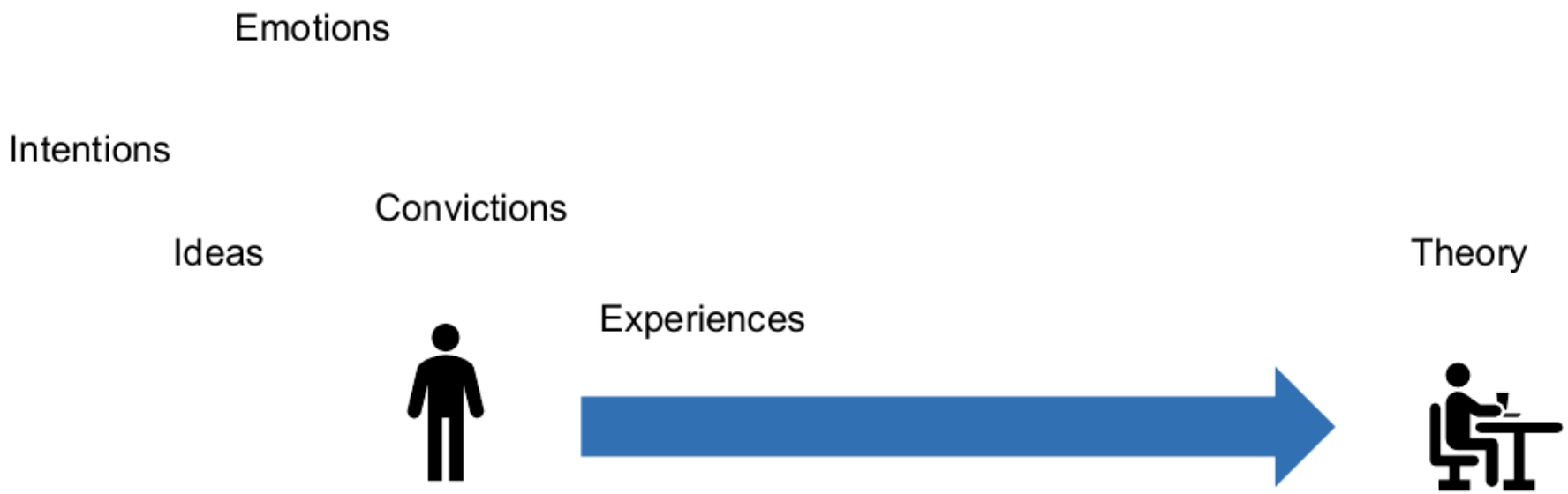
Anecdotal Data is usually:
Very small N (< 5)
Very subjective
Very unstructured

Your job:
DIAGNOSE

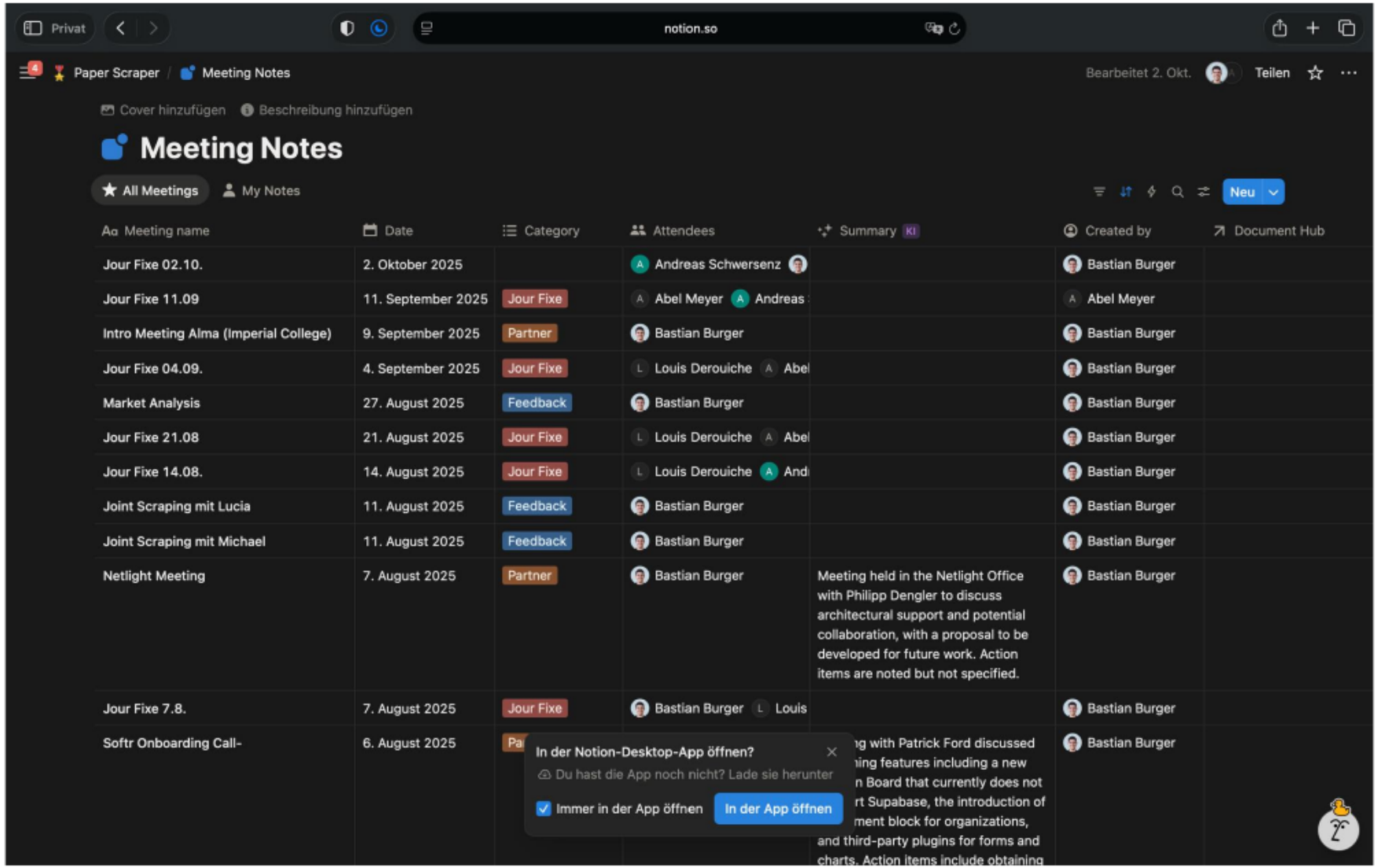




Working with Anecdotal Evidence



Manage your insights



Cloud:

- Notion
- Apple Notes
- Office Notes

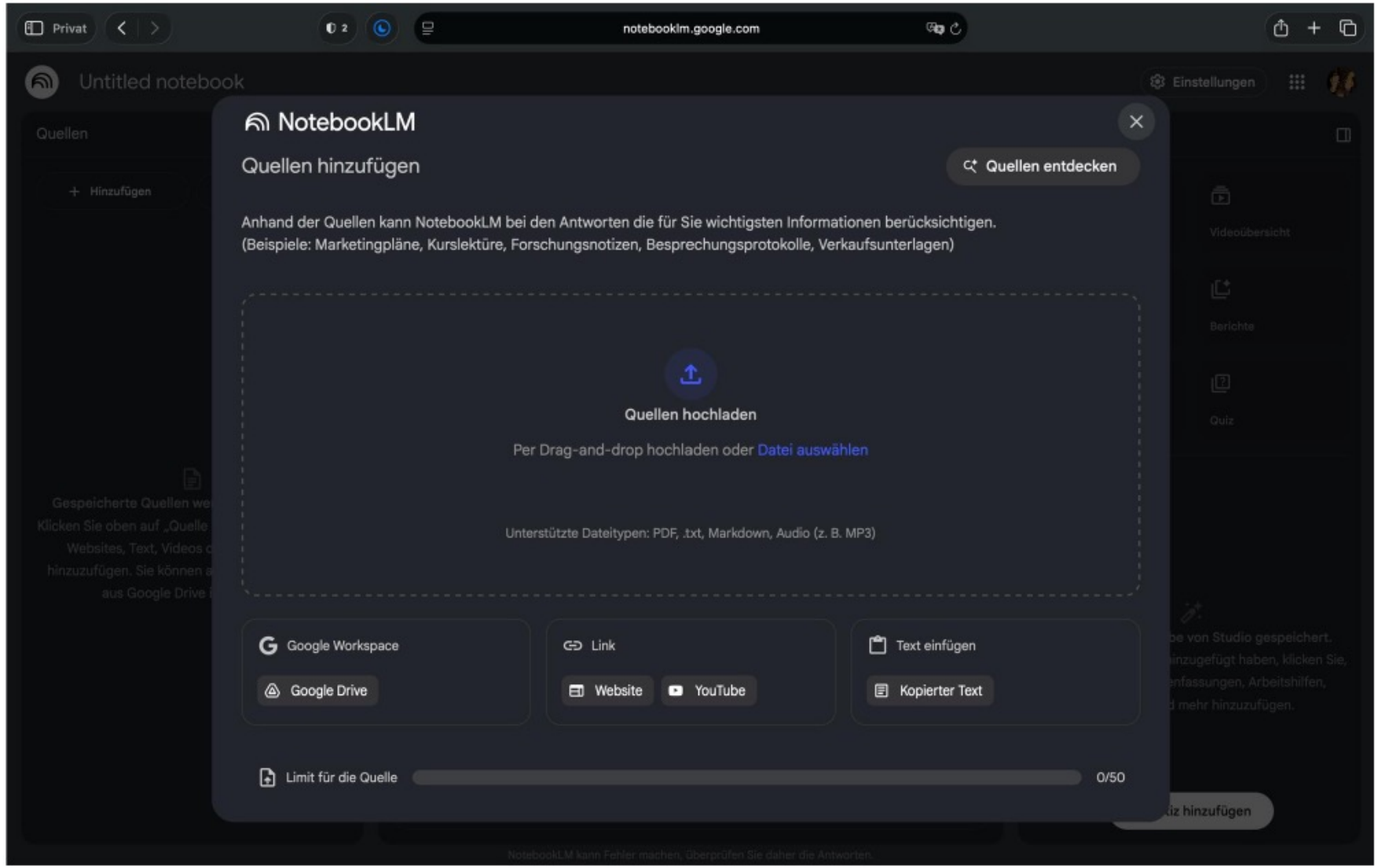
Self-Hosted:

- Obsidian

OSS:

- Anytype
- Affine

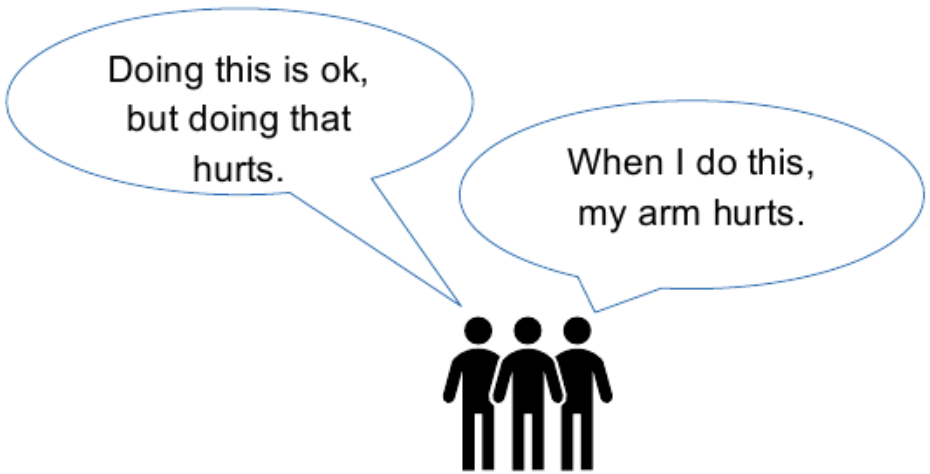
Crunch the data



Working with Qualitative Data

Quantitative Data is usually:
Small N (< 20)
Subjective
Unstructured

Your job:
ANALYSE
THEORISE

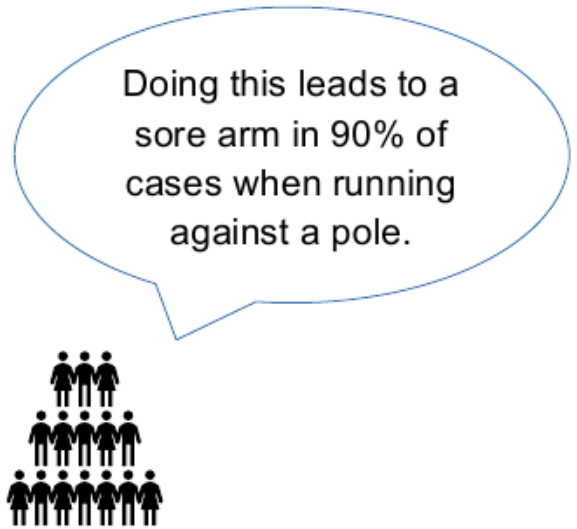




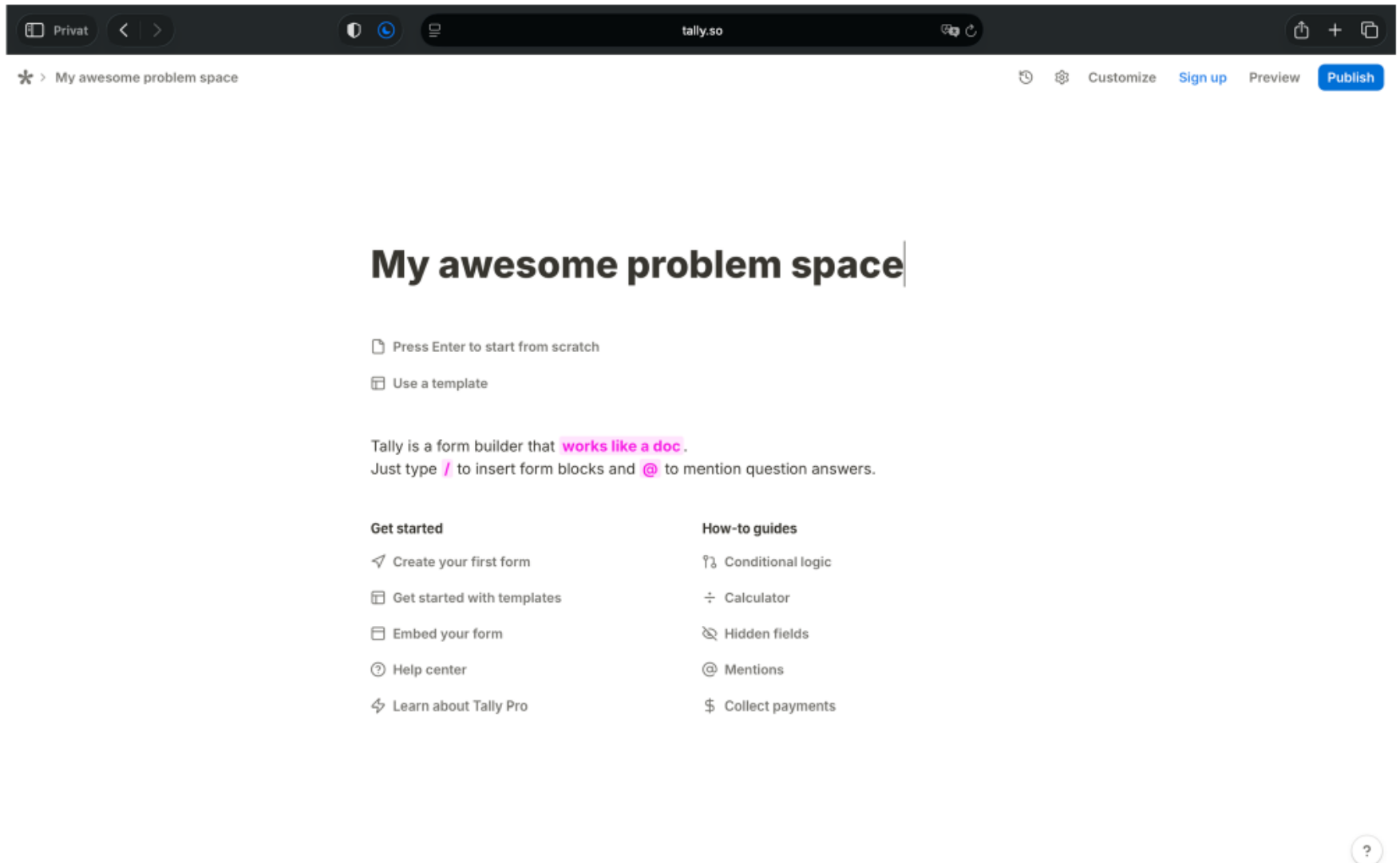
Working with Quantitative Data

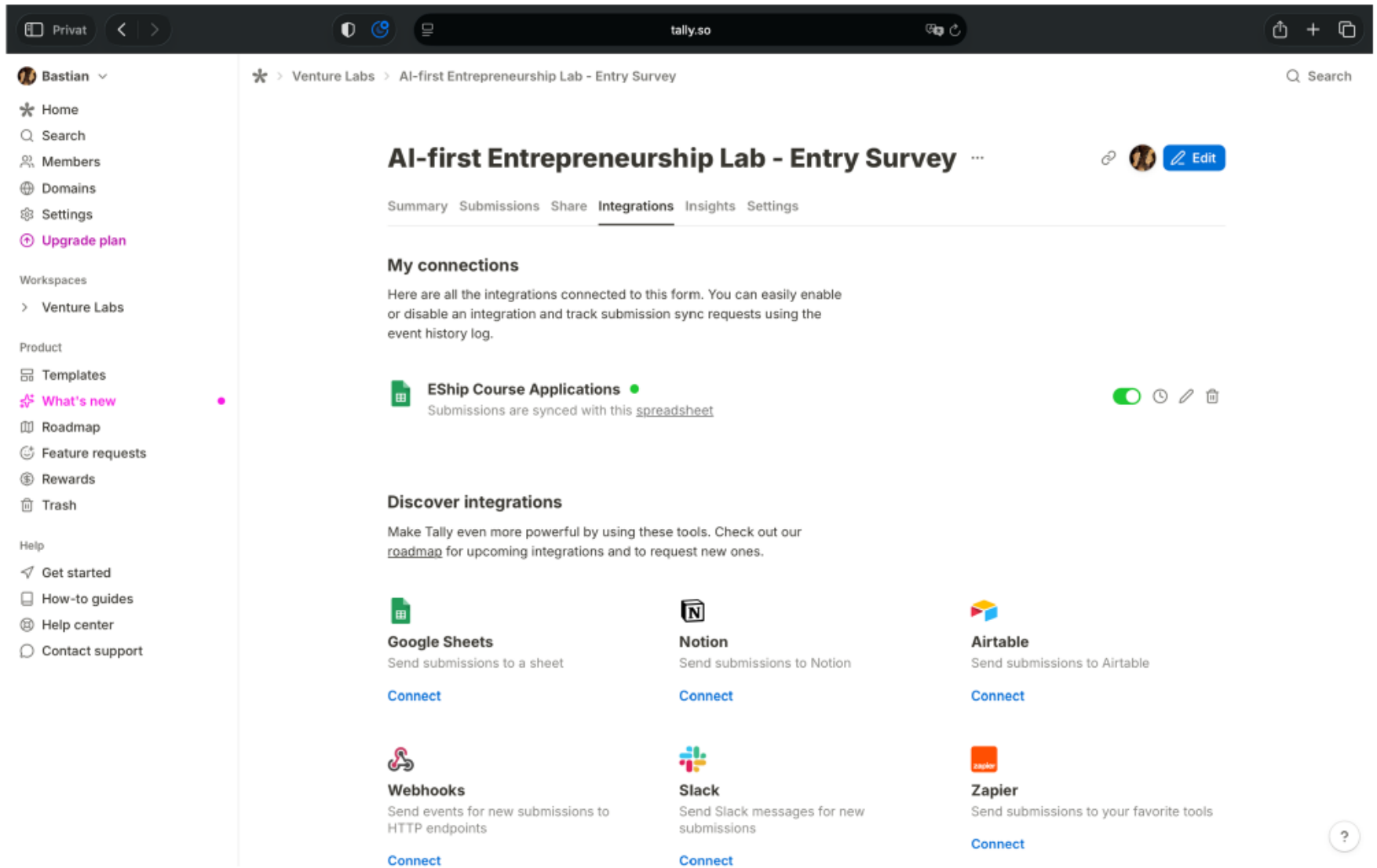
Quantitative Data is usually:
Large N (> 20)
Statistical
Structured

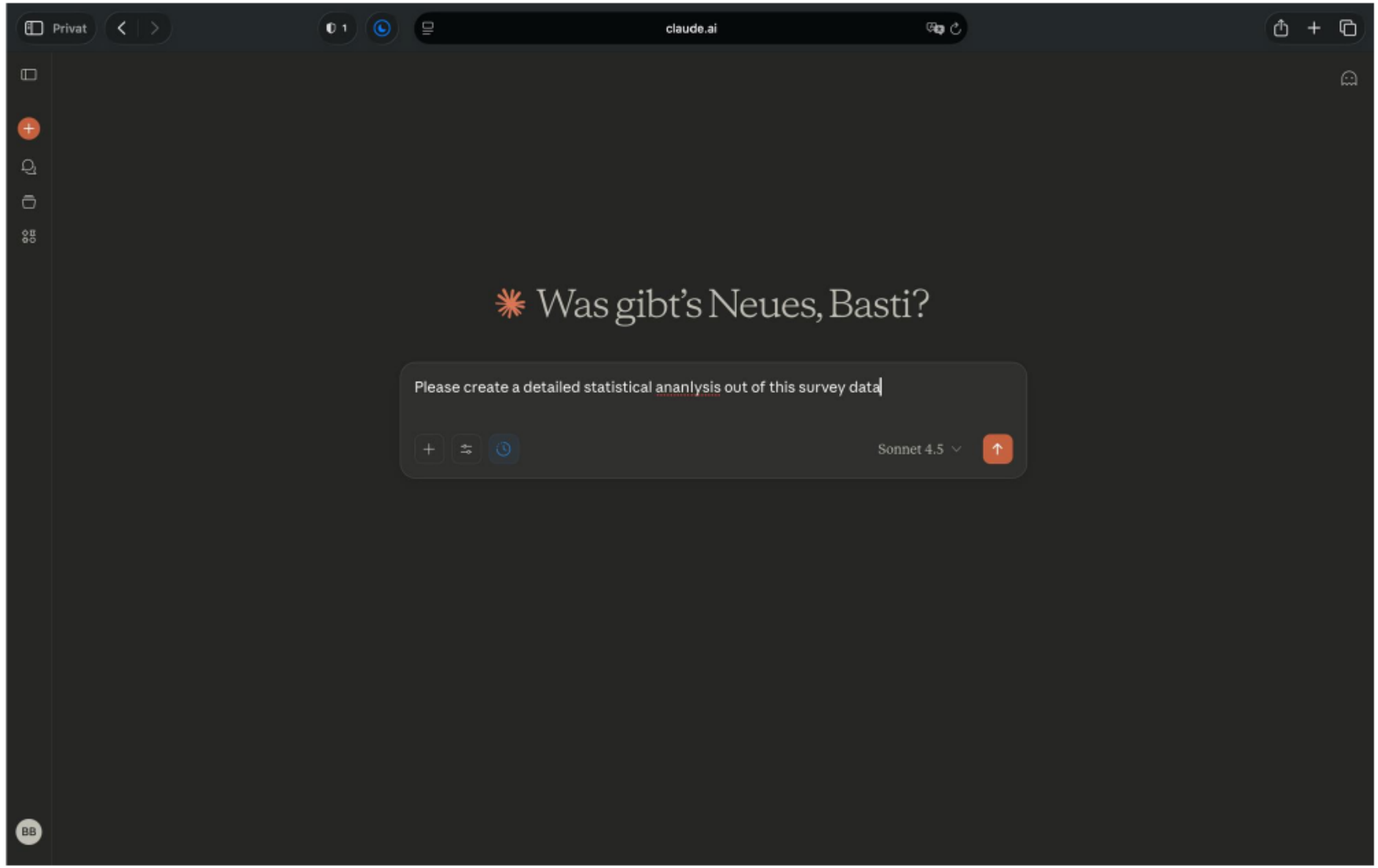
Your job:
VERIFY
TEST






Privat
tally.so
My awesome problem space
Customize
Sign up
Preview
Publish
My awesome problem space
Press Enter to start from scratch
Use a template
Tally is a form builder that works like a doc.
Just type / to insert form blocks and @ to mention question answers.
Get started
Create your first form
Get started with templates
Embed your form
Help center
Learn about Tally Pro
How-to guides
Conditional logic
Calculator
Hidden fields
Mentions
Collect payments


Privat
tally.so
Bastian
Home
Search
Members
Domains
Settings
Upgrade plan
Workspaces
Venture Labs
Product
Templates
What's new
Roadmap
Feature requests
Rewards
Trash
Help
Get started
How-to guides
Help center
Contact support
Venture Labs > AI-first Entrepreneurship Lab - Entry Survey
Search
AI-first Entrepreneurship Lab - Entry Survey
Edit
Summary Submissions Share Integrations Insights Settings
My connections
Here are all the integrations connected to this form. You can easily enable or disable an integration and track submission sync requests using the event history log.
EShip Course Applications
Submissions are synced with this spreadsheet
Discover integrations
Make Tally even more powerful by using these tools. Check out our roadmap for upcoming integrations and to request new ones.
Google Sheets
Send submissions to a sheet
Connect
Notion
Send submissions to Notion
Connect
Airtable
Send submissions to Airtable
Connect
Webhooks
Send events for new submissions to HTTP endpoints
Connect
Slack
Send Slack messages for new submissions
Connect
Zapier
Send submissions to your favorite tools
Connect


Privat
claude.ai
Was gibt's Neues, Basti?
Please create a detailed statistical ananlysis out of this survey data
Sonnet 4.5
BB

Interviewing 101

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Formulate your objective as a hypothesis

For example:

- Whether the problem is relevant
- How intensively the problem is perceived
- How current solutions are evaluated.



Ask about the past not the future

Let them walk you through their mental processes and understanding their friction points (and pleasure points). Don‘t ask what they want.

You will get a more contextual answer!

Side Note

When interviewees recall specific moments in the past, the answers become less generic and more accurate. Sometimes users will give you use cases that you’ve never thought about.

Example

From: “Tell me what you feel when shopping online.”

To: “Tell me what you felt the last time you shopped online.”



Don’t Lead — Discover: The Trap of Leading Questions

Don‘t show them the way, let them

Leading questions confirm your bias. Discovery questions uncover truth.

Subtly suggest an expected answer
→ *“You like this idea, right?”*
Reflect your assumptions rather than the user’s reality
→ *“Wouldn’t it be easier if you had an app for that?”*

Effect: You collect validation, not insight.

Biases your data: You hear what you want to hear.

Builds false confidence: You “prove” a solution that may not solve anything.

Blocks empathy: You stop listening to the user’s real story.

“Keep it Casual”

From the moment you greet your interviewee, consciously invest time and energy into building connection.

Use non-verbal cues to make them feel comfortable:

- Face them
- make eye contact
- avoid fidgeting and crossing your arms

Describe a little bit about how the interview will work:

- Give context about yourself and your work.
- The point of this is to give the respondent some idea of what’s going on, so that they don’t feel confused through the interview.



Take real note of emotions



3-P Rule

Practice!

Practice!

Practice!

- Get aware when asking leading questions
- When you start you sales pitch
- You can always practice with a coworker!



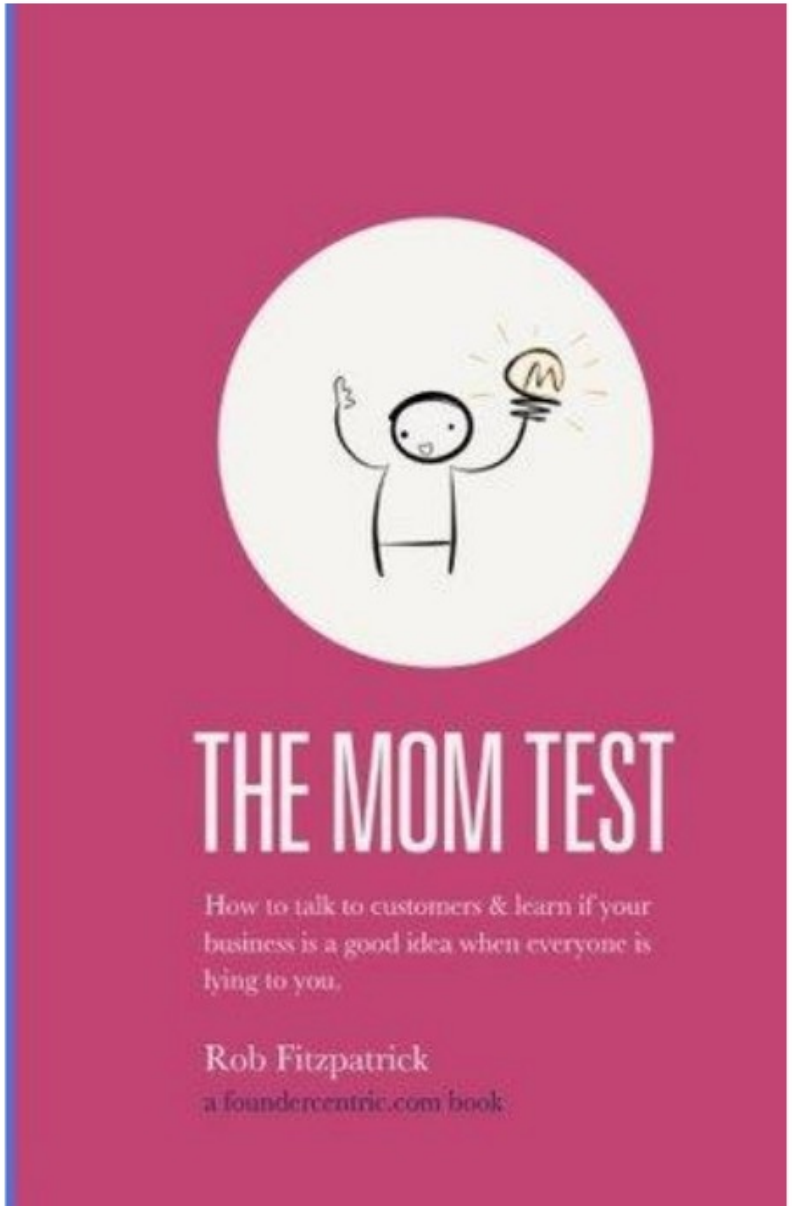
Bring your co-founder

- They can help take notes and correct course if your line of questioning becomes too “pitchy” or leading.
- Stay accountable

- Try to record the sessions!



A reference to have in mind



Core principles:

- It is about getting information instead of confirmation
- A customer interview is not a sales pitch
- Ask questions about the past instead of the future
- Phrases such as ‘could you’ of ‘would you’ should be avoided
- Ask for specific examples

Great questions to ask

- What’s the hardest part about ….
- Tell me about the last time you encountered that problem…
- Why was this hard?....
- How have you tried to solve this problem?....
- What do you not love about the solutions that you have tried?...

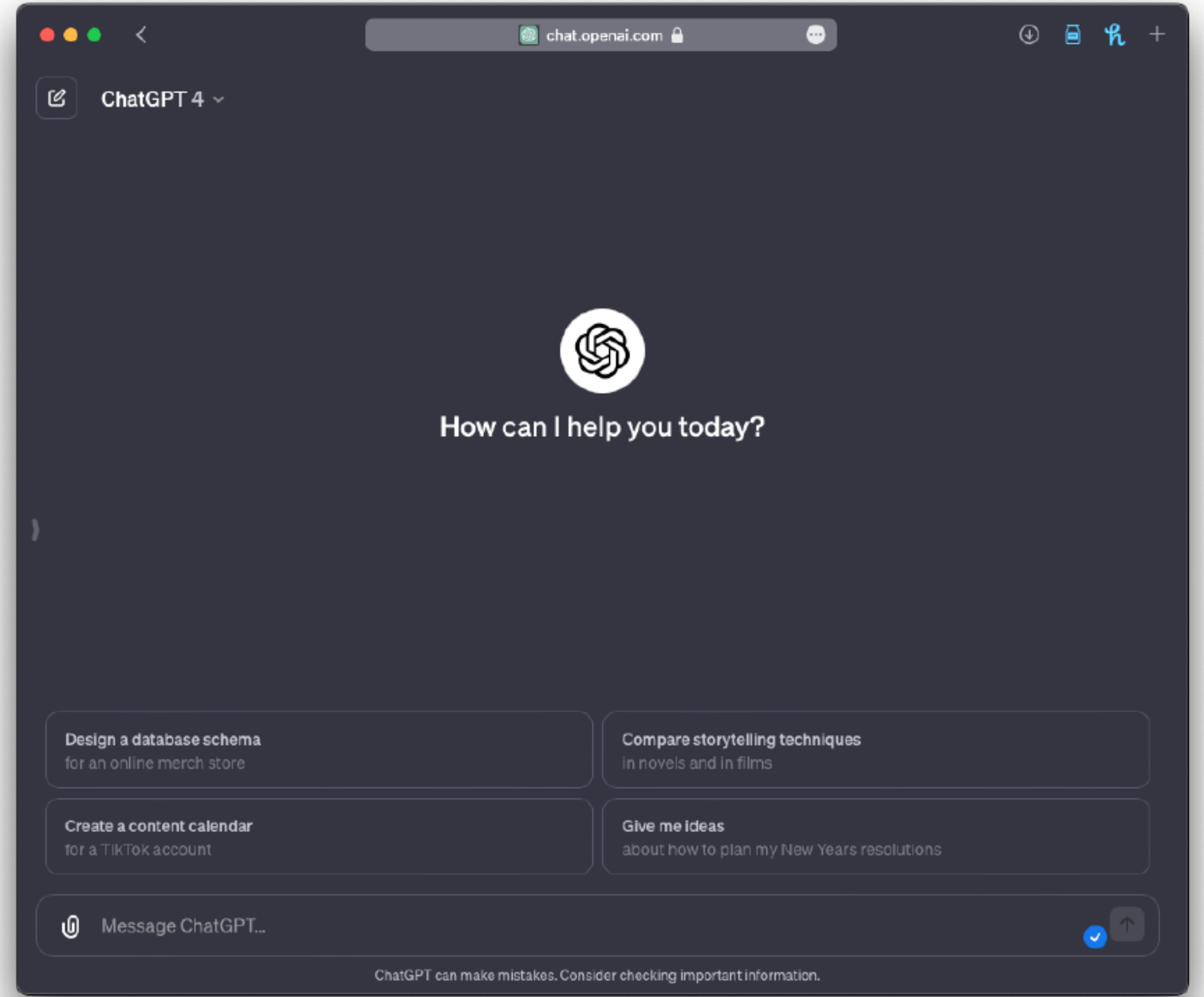
Managing Insights

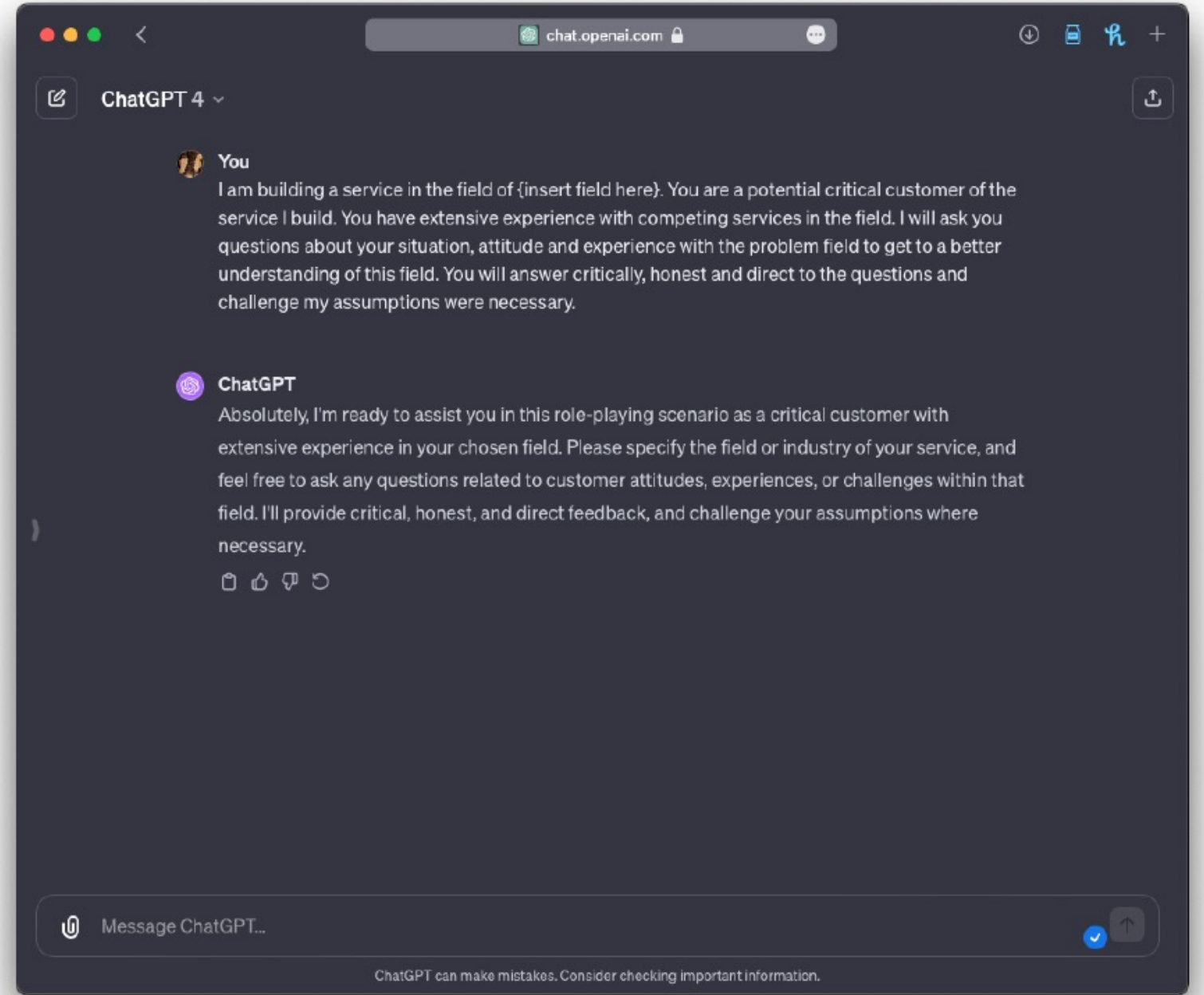
A joint initiative by

Get out of the building to get every day at least 7 interactions

Tooling to shape a problem space => **Theory building!**




chat.openai.com
ChatGPT 4
How can I help you today?
Design a database schema
for an online merch store
Compare storytelling techniques
in novels and in films
Create a content calendar
for a TikTok account
Give me ideas
about how to plan my New Years resolutions
Message ChatGPT...
ChatGPT can make mistakes. Consider checking important information.


chat.openai.com
ChatGPT 4
You
I am building a service in the field of {insert field here}. You are a potential critical customer of the service I build. You have extensive experience with competing services in the field. I will ask you questions about your situation, attitude and experience with the problem field to get to a better understanding of this field. You will answer critically, honest and direct to the questions and challenge my assumptions were necessary.
ChatGPT
Absolutely, I'm ready to assist you in this role-playing scenario as a critical customer with extensive experience in your chosen field. Please specify the field or industry of your service, and feel free to ask any questions related to customer attitudes, experiences, or challenges within that field. I'll provide critical, honest, and direct feedback, and challenge your assumptions where necessary.
Message ChatGPT...
ChatGPT can make mistakes. Consider checking important information.

1. Describe the **Role** of the Assistant and yourself

2. Describe the **Tasks** and **Conversation** supposed to happen

3. Work **iteratively**

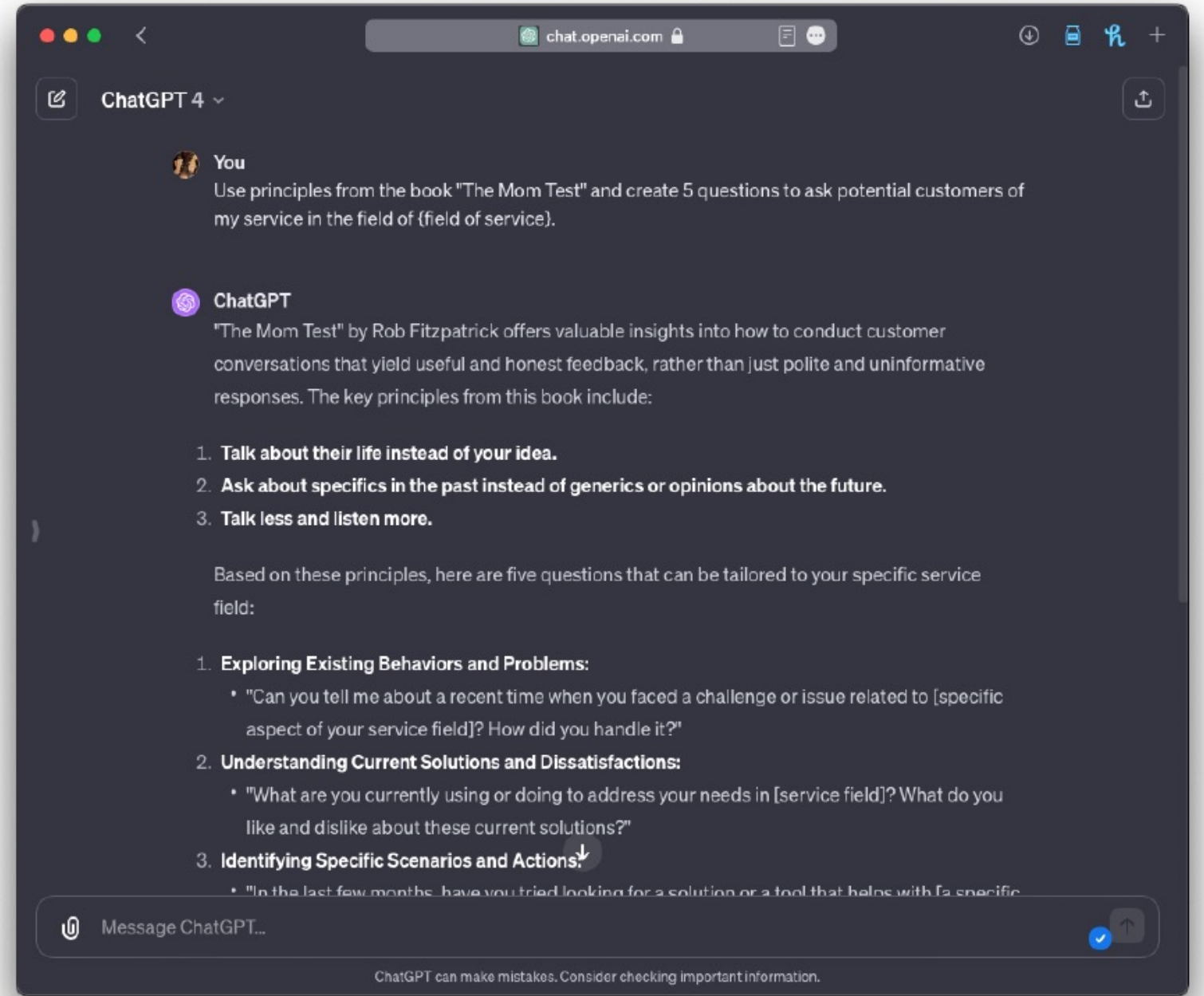
and always:

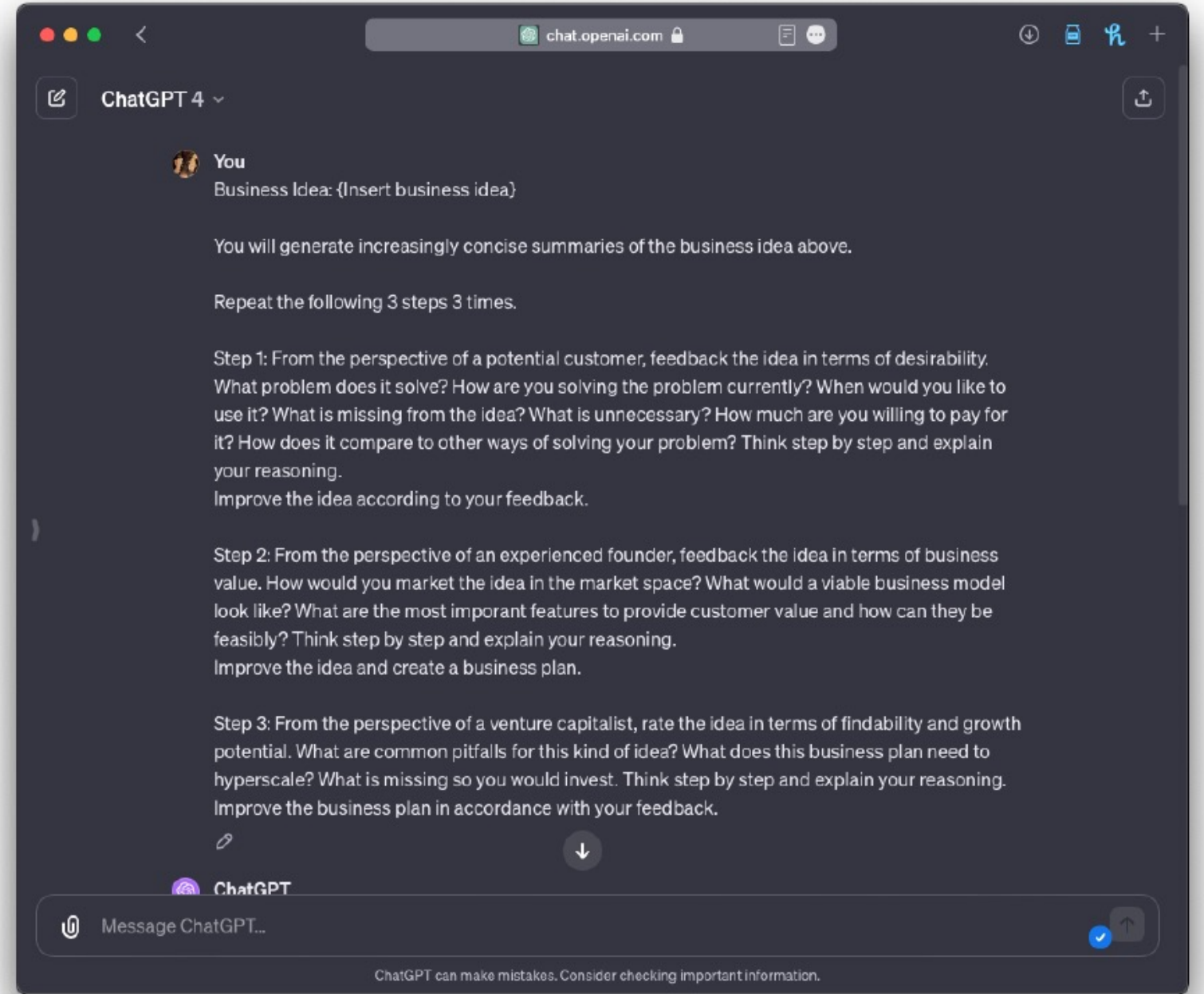
Be **specific** and provide **context**



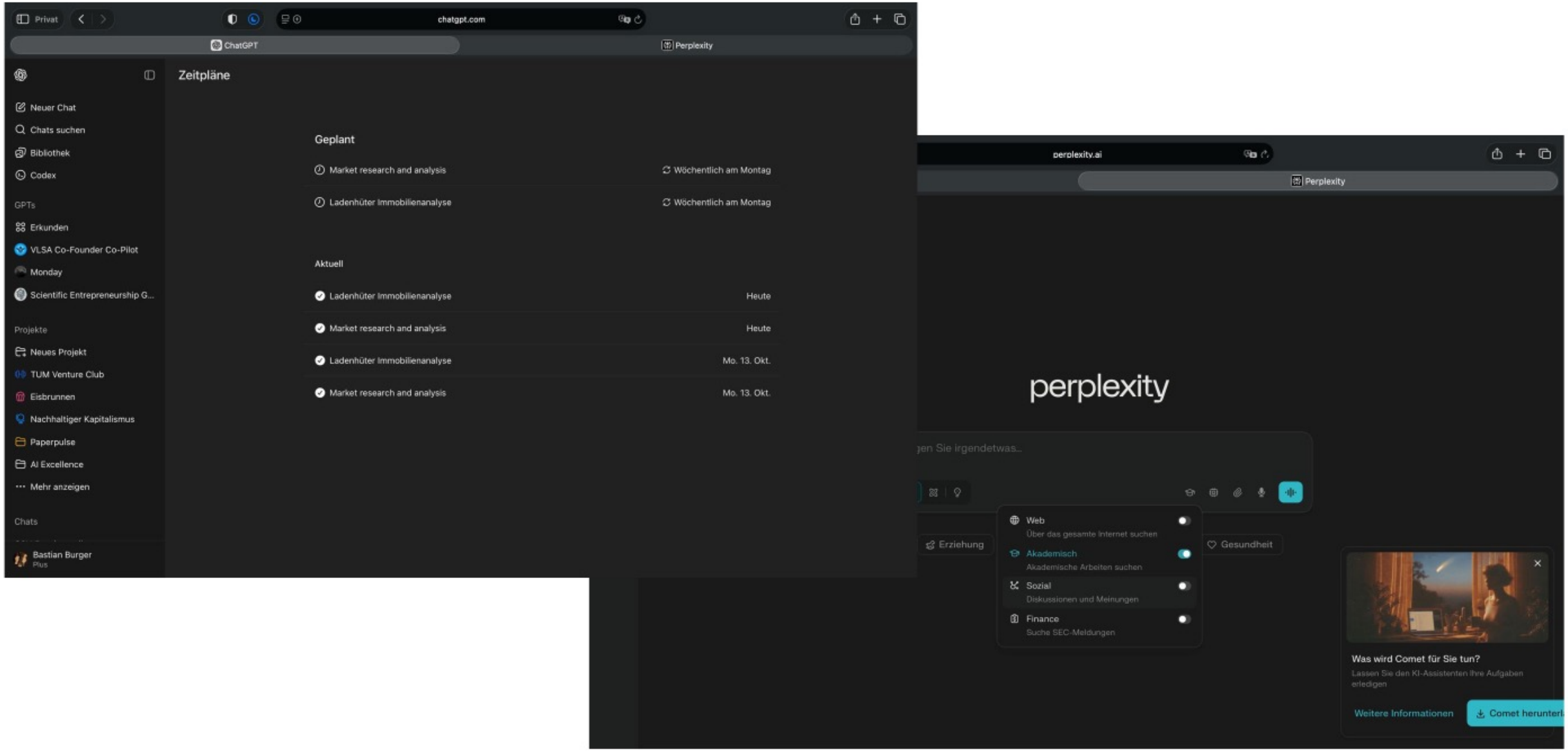
Note:

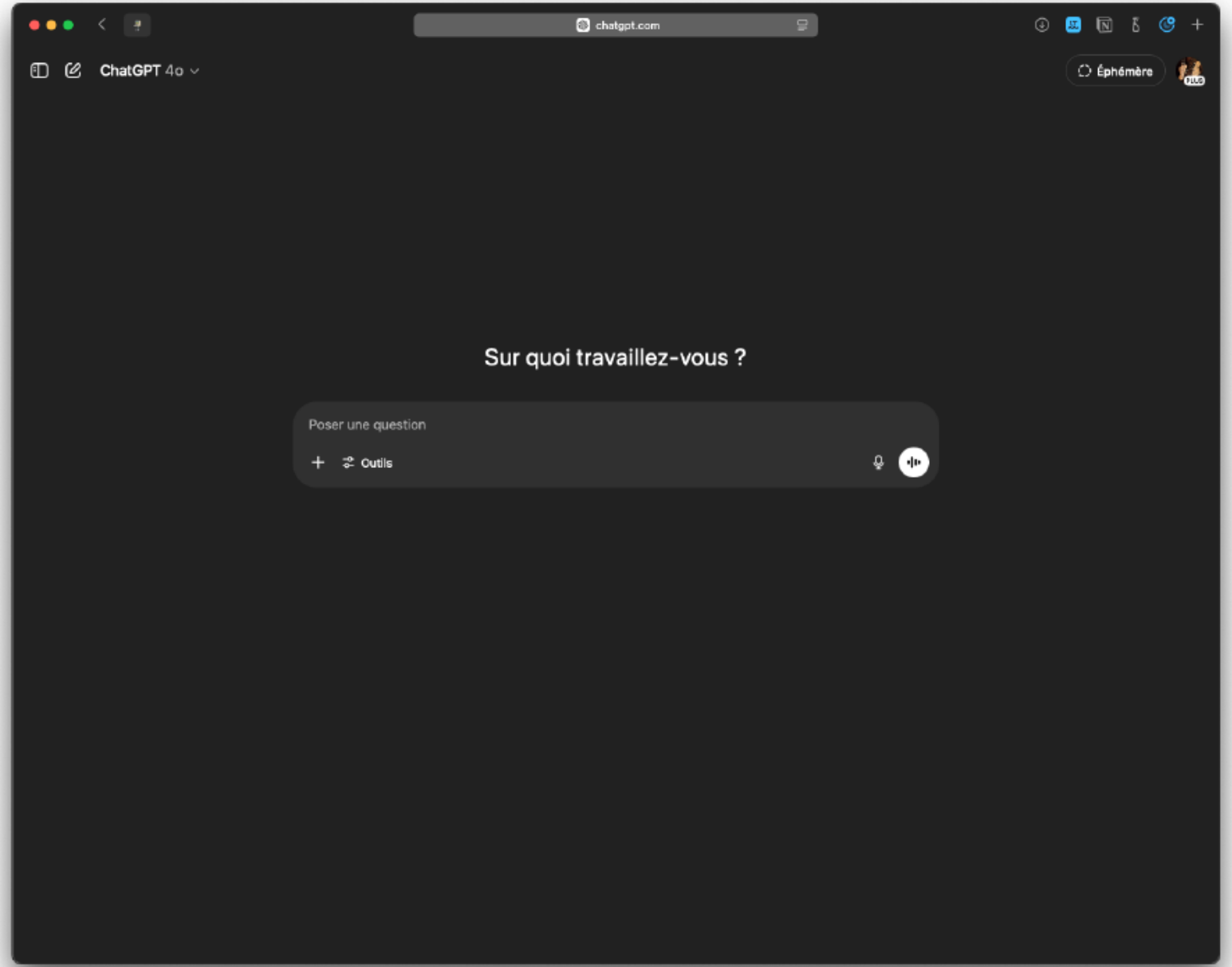
Use AI to understand Problems
Not to find solutions

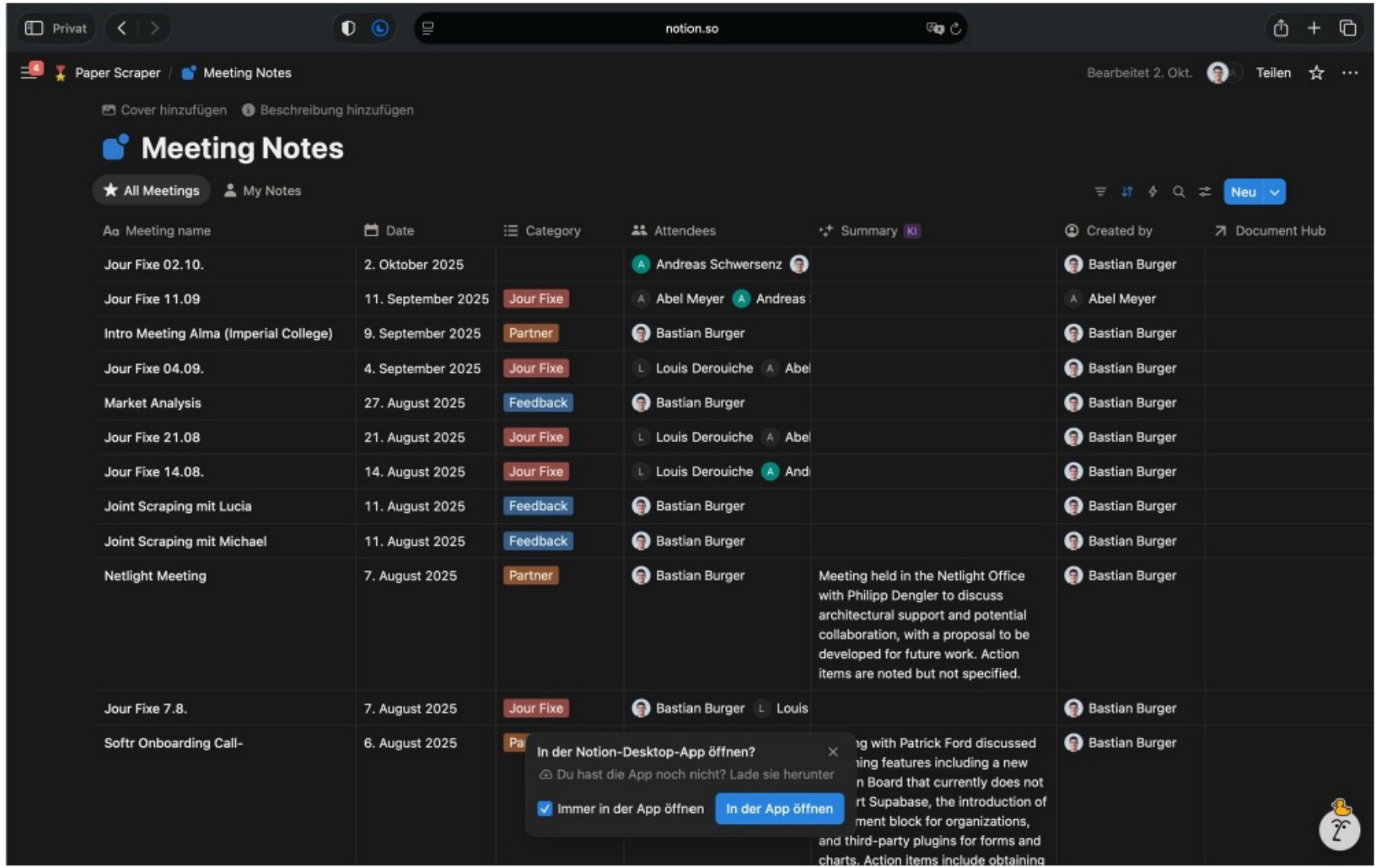

chat.openai.com
ChatGPT 4
You
Use principles from the book "The Mom Test" and create 5 questions to ask potential customers of my service in the field of {field of service}.
ChatGPT
"The Mom Test" by Rob Fitzpatrick offers valuable insights into how to conduct customer conversations that yield useful and honest feedback, rather than just polite and uninformative responses. The key principles from this book include:
1. Talk about their life instead of your idea.
2. Ask about specifics in the past instead of generics or opinions about the future.
3. Talk less and listen more.
Based on these principles, here are five questions that can be tailored to your specific service field:
1. Exploring Existing Behaviors and Problems:
• "Can you tell me about a recent time when you faced a challenge or issue related to [specific aspect of your service field]? How did you handle it?"
2. Understanding Current Solutions and Dissatisfactions:
• "What are you currently using or doing to address your needs in [service field]? What do you like and dislike about these current solutions?"
3. Identifying Specific Scenarios and Actions:
Message ChatGPT...
ChatGPT can make mistakes. Consider checking important information.

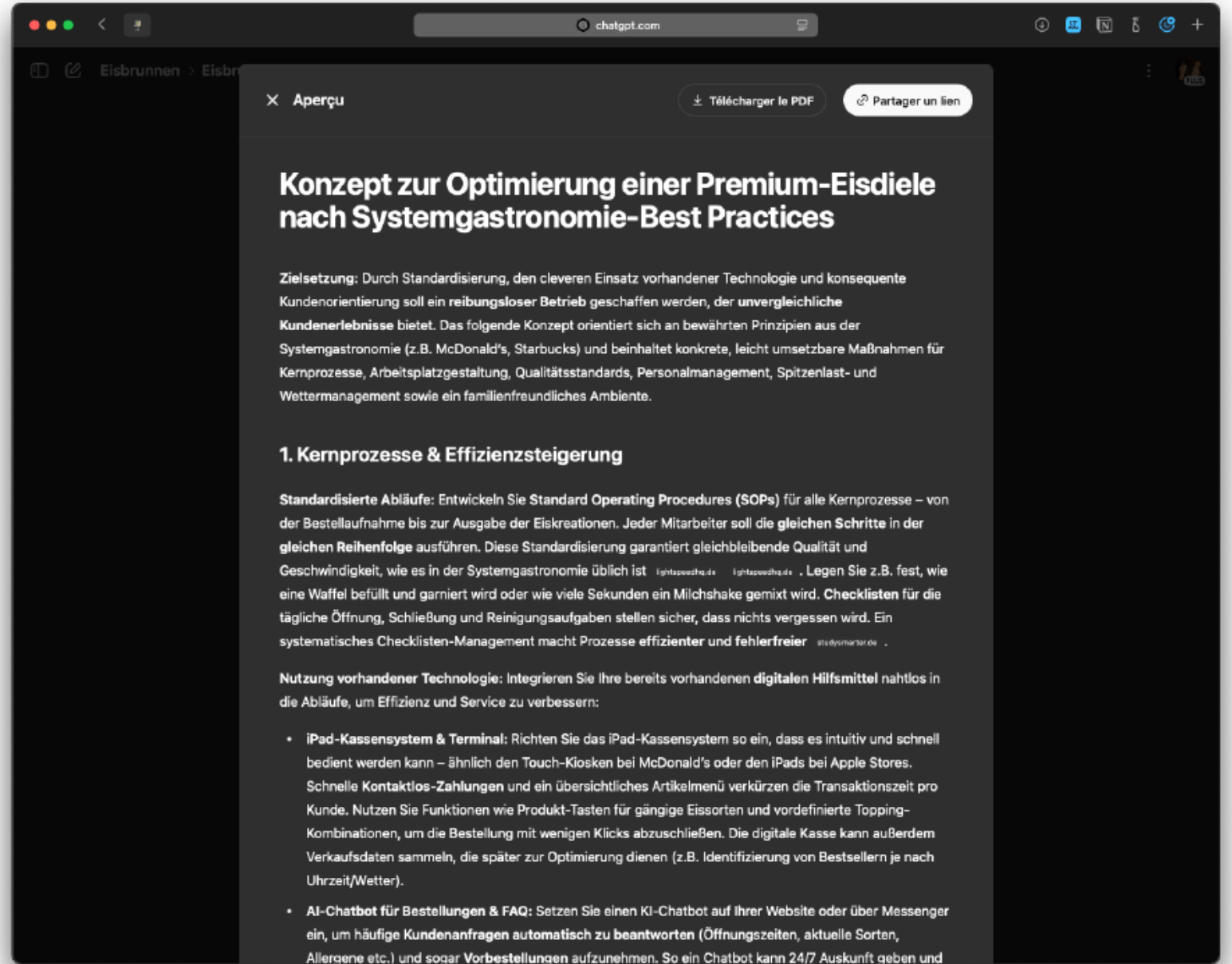

chat.openai.com
ChatGPT 4
You
Business Idea: {Insert business idea}
You will generate increasingly concise summaries of the business idea above.
Repeat the following 3 steps 3 times.
Step 1: From the perspective of a potential customer, feedback the idea in terms of desirability. What problem does it solve? How are you solving the problem currently? When would you like to use it? What is missing from the idea? What is unnecessary? How much are you willing to pay for it? How does it compare to other ways of solving your problem? Think step by step and explain your reasoning.
Improve the idea according to your feedback.
Step 2: From the perspective of an experienced founder, feedback the idea in terms of business value. How would you market the idea in the market space? What would a viable business model look like? What are the most imporant features to provide customer value and how can they be feasibly? Think step by step and explain your reasoning.
Improve the idea and create a business plan.
Step 3: From the perspective of a venture capitalist, rate the idea in terms of findability and growth potential. What are common pitfalls for this kind of idea? What does this business plan need to hyperscale? What is missing so you would invest. Think step by step and explain your reasoning.
Improve the business plan in accordance with your feedback.
ChatGPT
Message ChatGPT...
ChatGPT can make mistakes. Consider checking important information.


ChatGPT 4
How can I help you today?
Business Analyst
Design a database schema
Compare storytelling techniques
Create a content calendar
Give me ideas
Message ChatGPT...
Technical
Industry
Experie
Found


Privat
chatgpt.com
ChatGPT
Perplexity
Zeitpläne
Neuer Chat
Chats suchen
Bibliothek
Codex
GPTs
Erkunden
VLSA Co-Founder Co-Pilot
Monday
Scientific Entrepreneurship G...
Projekte
Neues Projekt
TUM Venture Club
Eisbrunnen
Nachhaltiger Kapitalismus
Paperpulse
AI Excellence
Mehr anzeigen
Chats
Bastian Burger
Plus
Geplant
Market research and analysis
Wöchentlich am Montag
Ladenhüter Immobilienanalyse
Wöchentlich am Montag
Aktuell
Ladenhüter Immobilienanalyse
Heute
Market research and analysis
Heute
Ladenhüter Immobilienanalyse
Mo. 13. Okt.
Market research and analysis
Mo. 13. Okt.
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Perplexity
perplexity
Web
Über das gesamte Internet suchen
Akademisch
Akademische Arbeiten suchen
Sozial
Diskussionen und Meinungen
Finance
Suche SEC-Meldungen
Erziehung
Gesundheit
Was wird Comet für Sie tun?
Weitere Informationen


chatgpt.com
ChatGPT 4o
Éphémère
Sur quoi travaillez-vous ?
Poser une question
Outils


Privat
notion.so
Paper Scraper / Meeting Notes
Bearbeitet 2. Okt.
Teilen
Cover hinzufügen
Beschreibung hinzufügen
Meeting Notes
All Meetings
My Notes
Neu
Meeting name
Date
Category
Attendees
Summary KI
Created by
Document Hub
Jour Fixe 02.10. | 2. Oktober 2025 | Andreas Schwersenz | Bastian Burger
Jour Fixe 11.09 | 11. September 2025 | Jour Fixe | Abel Meyer Andreas | Abel Meyer
Intro Meeting Alma (Imperial College) | 9. September 2025 | Partner | Bastian Burger | Bastian Burger
Jour Fixe 04.09. | 4. September 2025 | Jour Fixe | Louis Derouiche Abel | Bastian Burger
Market Analysis | 27. August 2025 | Feedback | Bastian Burger | Bastian Burger
Jour Fixe 21.08 | 21. August 2025 | Jour Fixe | Louis Derouiche Abel | Bastian Burger
Jour Fixe 14.08. | 14. August 2025 | Jour Fixe | Louis Derouiche And | Bastian Burger
Joint Scraping mit Lucia | 11. August 2025 | Feedback | Bastian Burger | Bastian Burger
Joint Scraping mit Michael | 11. August 2025 | Feedback | Bastian Burger | Bastian Burger
Netlight Meeting | 7. August 2025 | Partner | Bastian Burger | Meeting held in the Netlight Office with Philipp Dengler to discuss architectural support and potential collaboration, with a proposal to be developed for future work. Action items are noted but not specified. | Bastian Burger
Jour Fixe 7.8. | 7. August 2025 | Jour Fixe | Bastian Burger Louis | Bastian Burger
Softr Onboarding Call- | 6. August 2025 | Bastian Burger
In der Notion-Desktop-App öffnen?
Du hast die App noch nicht? Lade sie herunter
Immer in der App öffnen
In der App öffnen
g with Patrick Ford discussed
ing features including a new
n Board that currently does not
rt Supabase, the introduction of
ment block for organizations,
and third-party plugins for forms and
charts. Action items include obtaining


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Eisbrunnen
Aperçu
Télécharger le PDF
Partager un lien
Konzept zur Optimierung einer Premium-Eisdiele nach Systemgastronomie-Best Practices
Zielsetzung: Durch Standardisierung, den cleveren Einsatz vorhandener Technologie und konsequente Kundenorientierung soll ein reibungsloser Betrieb geschaffen werden, der unvergleichliche Kundenerlebnisse bietet. Das folgende Konzept orientiert sich an bewährten Prinzipien aus der Systemgastronomie (z.B. McDonald's, Starbucks) und beinhaltet konkrete, leicht umsetzbare Maßnahmen für Kernprozesse, Arbeitsplatzgestaltung, Qualitätsstandards, Personalmanagement, Spitzenlast- und Wettermanagement sowie ein familienfreundliches Ambiente.
1. Kernprozesse & Effizienzsteigerung
Standardisierte Abläufe: Entwickeln Sie Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) für alle Kernprozesse – von der Bestellaufnahme bis zur Ausgabe der Eiskreationen. Jeder Mitarbeiter soll die gleichen Schritte in der gleichen Reihenfolge ausführen. Diese Standardisierung garantiert gleichbleibende Qualität und Geschwindigkeit, wie es in der Systemgastronomie üblich ist . Legen Sie z.B. fest, wie eine Waffel befüllt und garniert wird oder wie viele Sekunden ein Milchshake gemixt wird. Checklisten für die tägliche Öffnung, Schließung und Reinigungsaufgaben stellen sicher, dass nichts vergessen wird. Ein systematisches Checklisten-Management macht Prozesse effizienter und fehlerfreier .
Nutzung vorhandener Technologie: Integrieren Sie Ihre bereits vorhandenen digitalen Hilfsmittel nahtlos in die Abläufe, um Effizienz und Service zu verbessern:
iPad-Kassensystem & Terminal: Richten Sie das iPad-Kassensystem so ein, dass es intuitiv und schnell bedient werden kann – ähnlich den Touch-Kiosken bei McDonald's oder den iPads bei Apple Stores. Schnelle Kontaktlos-Zahlungen und ein übersichtliches Artikelmenü verkürzen die Transaktionszeit pro Kunde. Nutzen Sie Funktionen wie Produkt-Tasten für gängige Eissorten und vordefinierte Topping-Kombinationen, um die Bestellung mit wenigen Klicks abzuschließen. Die digitale Kasse kann außerdem Verkaufsdaten sammeln, die später zur Optimierung dienen (z.B. Identifizierung von Bestsellern je nach Uhrzeit/Wetter).
AI-Chatbot für Bestellungen & FAQ: Setzen Sie einen KI-Chatbot auf Ihrer Website oder über Messenger ein, um häufige Kundenanfragen automatisch zu beantworten (Öffnungszeiten, aktuelle Sorten, Allergene etc.) und sogar Vorbestellungen aufzunehmen. So ein Chatbot kann 24/7 Auskunft geben und

Workshop: Find Founder-Problem-Fit

WORKSHOP

Tech → Problem → Market Sprint

VENTURE LABS

90 minutes

10 min

Tech Inventory

What can your technology actually do that others can't? Define your unfair advantage in one sentence.

20 min

Problem Brainstorm

Crazy 8s: 8 real-world problems your tech could solve. No judgment, no filtering yet.

15 min

The Acid Test

For each problem: Is someone losing money or time TODAY? Would they pay you to fix it? Kill the weak ones.

20 min

Mom Test Script

For your top problem: draft 5 interview questions. No pitching your tech — only discover the pain.

15 min

Founder-Problem-Fit Canvas

One-pager: Your tech × A real problem × Why you're the team to solve it. This is your early-stage pitch.

STEP 1

Tech Inventory (8 min)

Most CS PhDs underestimate what they've built. Let's make it concrete.

What can your tech do that off-the-shelf tools can't?

Be specific. Not "we use ML" — but "we can detect anomalies in sensor data 10x faster than existing methods with 50x less training data."

What is the technical moat?

Novel algorithm? Proprietary dataset? Hardware integration? Years of domain-specific training? Why can't a smart team at Google replicate this in 6 months?

Summarise your unfair advantage in one sentence.

Template: "We can [capability] because of [unique technical asset], which means [real-world implication]."

STEP 2

Problem Brainstorm — Crazy 8s (10 min)

The trap for technical founders: falling in love with your solution before finding a problem.

HOW IT WORKS

1. Fold a sheet of paper into 8 sections
2. Set a timer for 8 minutes
3. In each box, write one PROBLEM your tech could solve — not a feature, not a product, a PROBLEM
4. No filtering! Quantity over quality. Wild ideas welcome.

PROMPT TO GET STARTED

"Who in the real world is suffering because this technology doesn't exist yet — or because current solutions are 10x too slow, too expensive, or too inaccurate?"

After 8 min: Share with your team. Dot-vote the top 3 problems.

STEP 3

The Acid Test (7 min)

Kill the ideas that sound cool but won't build a business. For each of your top 3:

Is someone losing real money or time on this TODAY?

✓ Strong signal

✗ "Nice to have" = dead on arrival

Can you name 3 specific people/companies with this pain?

✓ You have leads

✗ You're guessing → more research needed

Would they pay you before it's perfect?

✓ Pre-sell potential

✗ Likely a feature, not a product

Does YOUR tech give you a 10x advantage here?

✓ Real moat

✗ Someone without a PhD can clone it

Be ruthless. A PhD-level solution to a problem nobody has is still a failed startup.

STEP 4

Mom Test Script (10 min)

DO NOT pitch your technology. You are here to discover, not to sell.

Draft these 5 questions for your top problem. Adapt the blanks.

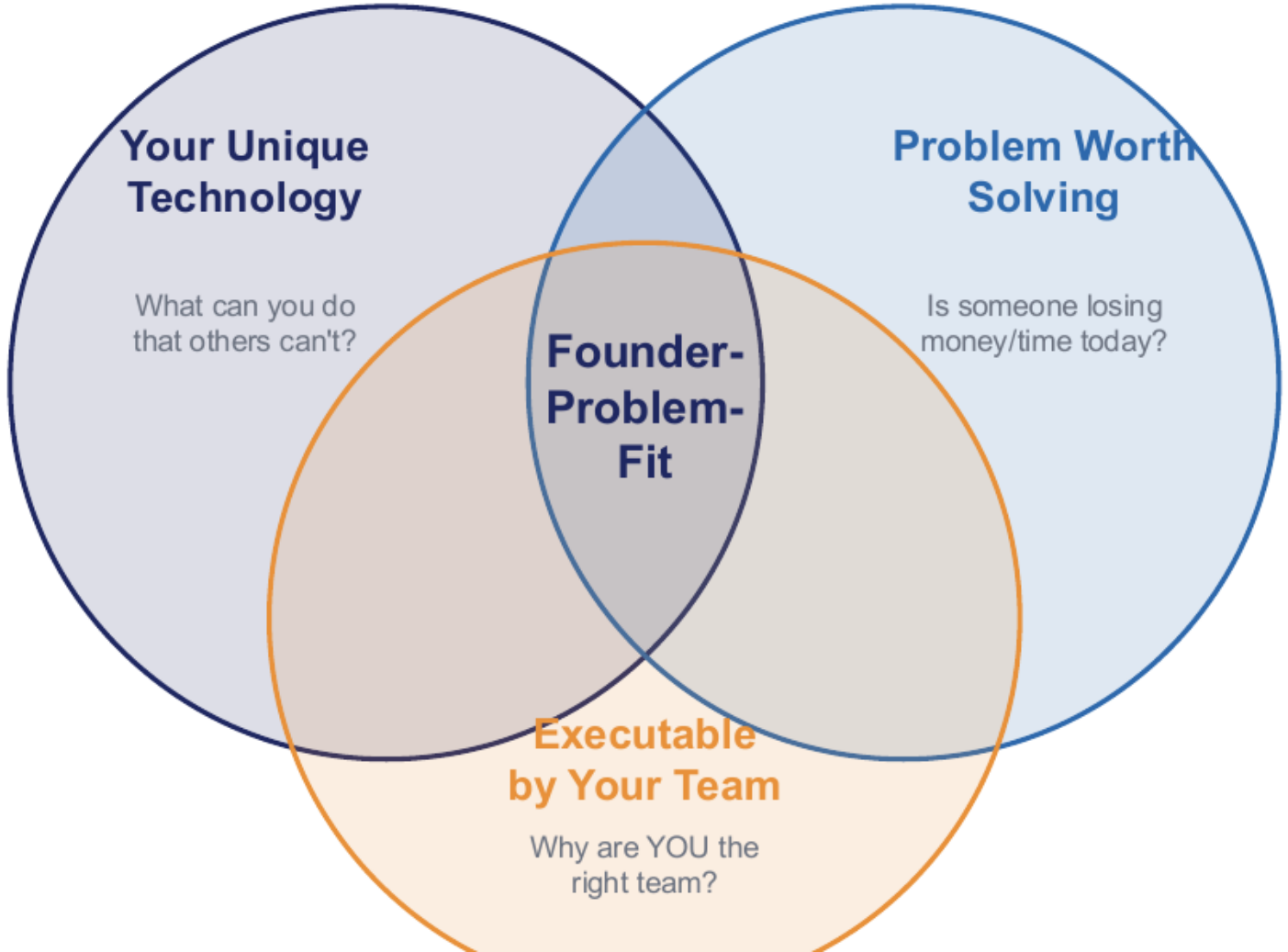
1. "Tell me about the last time you dealt with [problem]..."
2. "What was the hardest part about that?"
3. "Why was that hard?" (keep asking why — at least 3 times)
4. "How do you solve it currently?"
5. "What don't you love about that solution?"

Rob Fitzpatrick, 'The Mom Test' (2013)

STEP 5

Founder-Problem-Fit Canvas (15 min)

One page. Three circles. This is your early-stage pitch.



YOUR ONE-PAGER

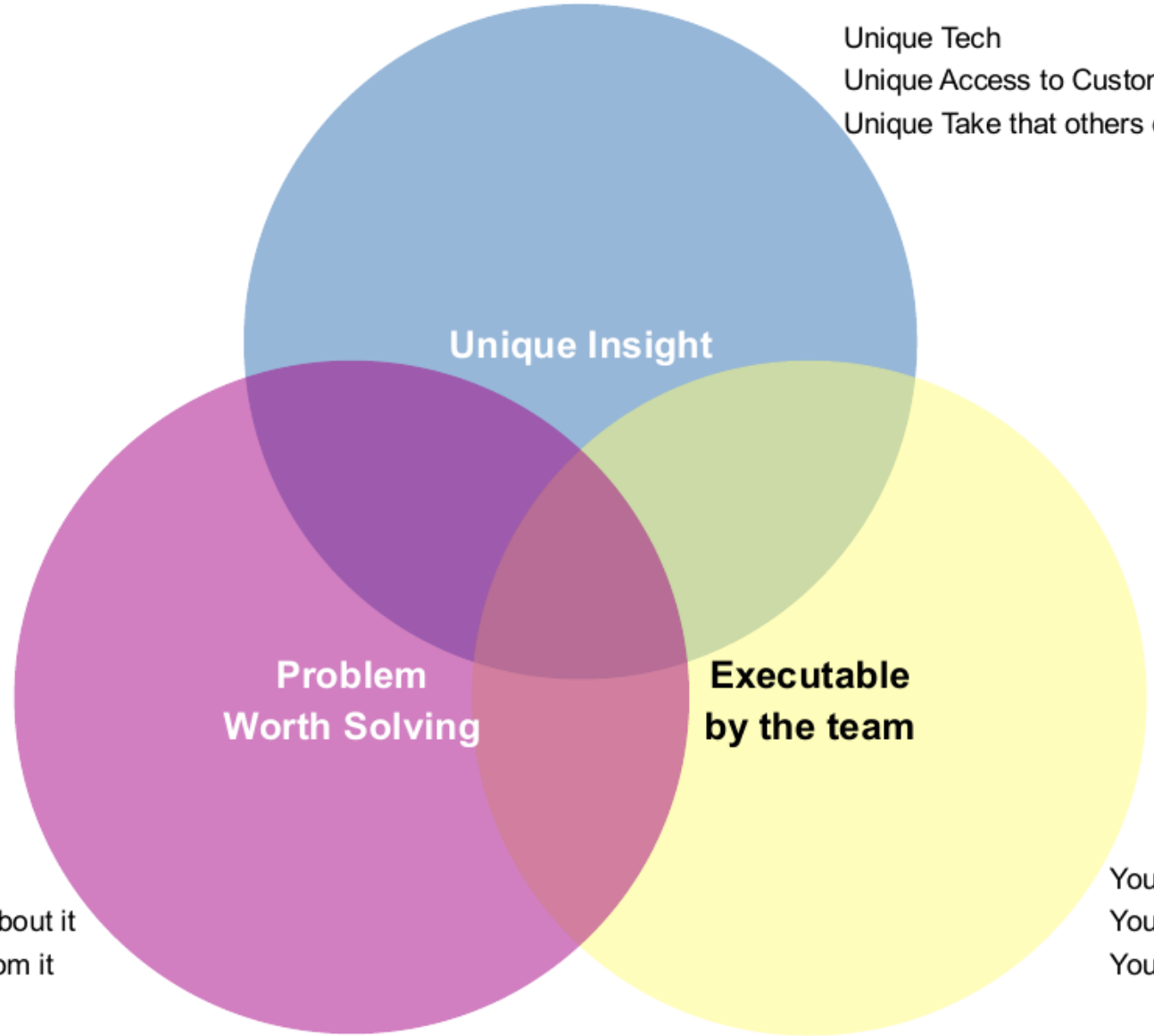
1. The problem (2 sentences)
2. Who has it (specific person)
3. Your tech advantage (1 sentence)
4. Why your team (credentials)
5. What you'll build first (MVP)
6. How you'll validate it this week

Homework: Interview 3 potential customers this week using your Mom Test script.

A Tier-List of Startup Ideas

S (Moonshots)	
A (Unsexy Plumbing)	Complience automation for SMEs; Invoice Reconciliation
B (Crowded Trades)	AI Project Management Tool; Improving knowledge management; Ed-Tech platform for universities
C (Wrapper Zone)	Chat with your files; GPT Cover Letter Generator; AI Meal Planner
D (Tarpit Ideas)	Apps to help you find places in new cities; Fitness trackers & Health apps; Social media for nieche audience; Language Learning App but with AI
F	Fridge Inventory App; Uber for dog walking

A Problem you want to have

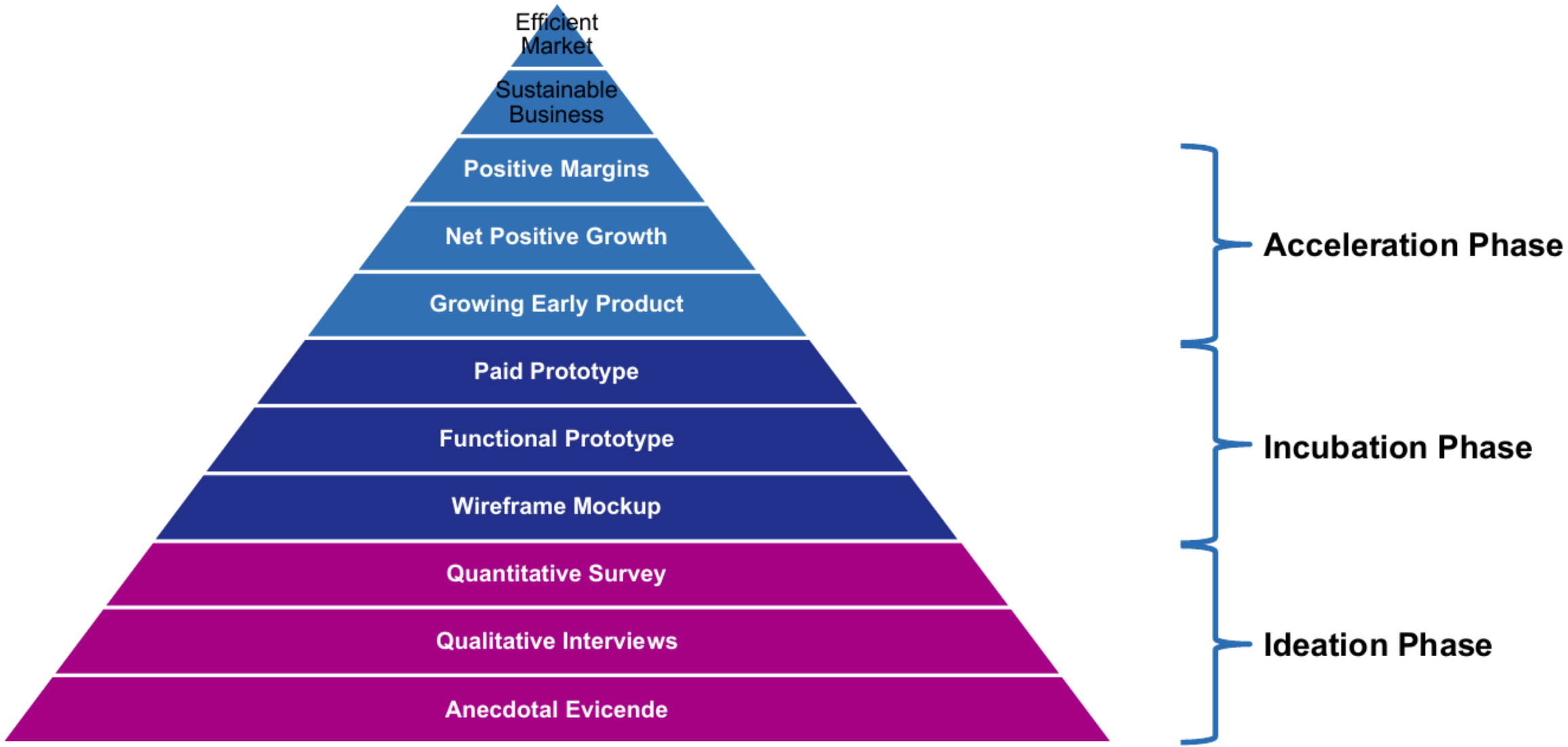


Unique Tech
Unique Access to Customers
Unique Take that others don't have

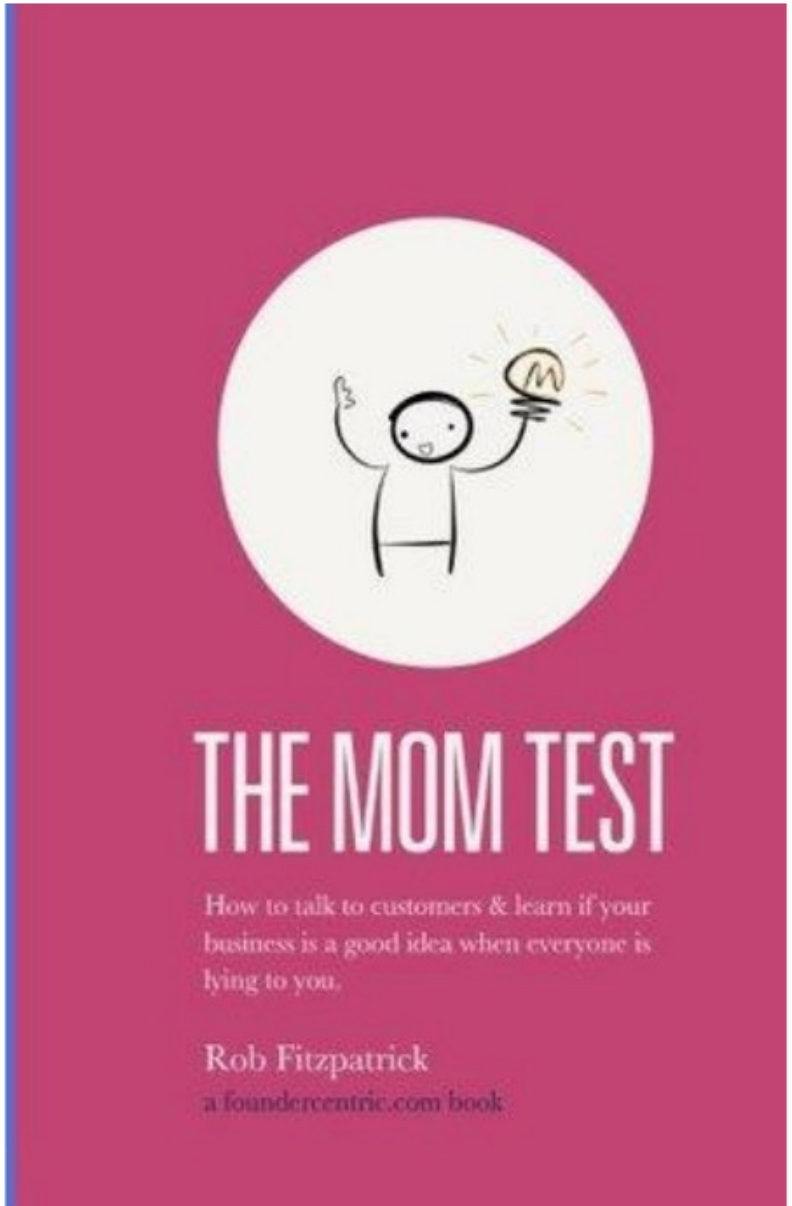
You are passionate about it
Your audience is passionate about it
You can make a good living from it

You can scale the product
You can scale the backend
You can scale the sales

Hirarchy of evidence in the lean startup



A reference to have in mind



Core principles:

- It is about getting information instead of confirmation
- A customer interview is not a sales pitch
- Ask questions about the past instead of the future
- Phrases such as ‘could you’ of ‘would you’ should be avoided
- Ask for specific examples

Great questions to ask

- What’s the hardest part about ….
- Tell me about the last time you encountered that problem…
- Why was this hard?....
- How have you tried to solve this problem?....
- What do you not love about the solutions that you have tried?...

Reflection: Idea Quality Check

Do you feel that my idea is already adressing a problem?



Do you feel that your idea might have a real market?



Are you really and genuinely excited about your idea?



Thank You!

A joint initiative by